

ENGLISH FOR ENERGY AND UTILITY TEAMS

Energy and Utilities English

Explain the status. Name the uncertainty. Make the measure clear.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For utility operations, customer communication, project, program, and asset-management teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight utility exchanges: correct an outage update, escalate an identifier conflict, explain a rate proposal, report an interconnection review, compare asset costs, hand over storm resources, qualify efficiency claims, and interpret reliability measures.

01 Grid Reliability and Outage Response

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An update time is not a restoration promise | Give a useful outage message while distinguishing affected scope, assessment status, and the next update.

02 Safety, Field Work, and Switching

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Two identifiers must not be treated as interchangeable | Escalate conflicting equipment references and use exact repeat-back without creating an operational instruction.

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Translate the system without changing its meaning

Utility conversations move between specialist records and decisions that affect customers. Translate jargon into clear language while preserving the difference between an estimate, an authorization, a measured result, and an unresolved question.

Put status beside the number

A time may refer to restoration, a crew arrival, or the next information update. Name what it measures and whether it is verified, estimated, requested, or still unavailable.

"The next update is at 16:40; that is not a restoration estimate."

Make identifiers exact

Similar equipment labels are not interchangeable. Raise a mismatch through the authorized process and keep the operational restriction explicit; a plausible correction is not verification.

"The work package says Q27; the switching request says Q72. The discrepancy remains unresolved."

Show the comparison basis

Purchase price, energy use, and interruption counts answer different questions. State the period, units, included costs or events, and assumptions before drawing a conclusion.

"This is a ten-year purchase-and-maintenance comparison, not the complete life-cycle cost."

Translate without overpromising

Plain language should make a technical boundary easier to understand, not remove it. A queued application is not an approved connection, and a lower meter reading is not by itself verified program savings.

"The application is in review; permission to operate has not been issued."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All organizations, projects, figures, equipment identifiers, and local processes are fictional. This is English-language practice, not electrical, emergency, financial, regulatory, or engineering instruction. Only qualified personnel using applicable authorized procedures may make operational decisions. No dialogue authorizes switching, access, energization, or restoration.

An update time is not a restoration promise

A Read the situation

Give a useful outage message while distinguishing affected scope, assessment status, and the next update.

At 16:10 local time, a verified operations update lists 420 affected service points in the Oak district. The cause and estimated restoration time remain under assessment. A crew is assigned, but its arrival has not been confirmed. A draft public message promises restoration by 18:00, although that figure is an unverified internal planning assumption. Communications officer Nia and operations liaison Paul must correct the draft. Paul will provide the next verified status at 16:40 local time, even if no restoration estimate is available. The affected count is a snapshot, not a prediction of the final scope.

PEOPLE / Nia: Communications officer | Paul: Operations liaison

UNCERTAINTY NEEDS A USEFUL NEXT STEP

Customers can hear we do not know as abandonment if the message stops there. Give the confirmed scope, explain what remains under assessment, and state the next update commitment. Do not manufacture confidence by converting a planning assumption into a promise.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is verified at 16:10?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A A confirmed equipment failure | B Crew arrival at every affected location |
| C 420 affected service points in the Oak district | D Restoration by 18:00 |

2. What does 16:40 represent?

- | | |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A The next status update | B Guaranteed restoration |
| C Confirmed crew arrival | D The start of the outage |

3. Which crew statement is accurate?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A crew has completed the repair. | B Every crew is on site. |
| C No crew has been assigned. | D A crew is assigned; arrival is unconfirmed. |

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

electric grid

The interconnected infrastructure delivering electricity from sources to users.

IN USE maintain the electric grid

transmission

Bulk movement of electricity over the relevant high-voltage network.

IN USE coordinate transmission operations

distribution

Delivery of electricity through the network serving end users.

IN USE restore distribution service

feeder

A circuit supplying a section of the distribution network.

IN USE identify the affected feeder

substation

A facility connecting, transforming, or controlling parts of an electrical network.

IN USE identify the supplying substation

service point

A defined point at which service is supplied or measured.

IN USE count affected service points

outage

A loss or unavailability of electricity service or equipment function.

IN USE report an outage

outage footprint

The area or set of service points affected by an outage.

IN USE verify the outage footprint

estimated restoration time (ERT)

The current estimate of when interrupted service may be restored.

IN USE update the estimated restoration time

damage assessment

Evaluation of damage and relevant conditions following an event.

IN USE coordinate damage assessment

crew assignment

Allocation of a crew to an identified task or response.

IN USE confirm the crew assignment

crew arrival

The crew reaching the relevant location, distinct from being assigned.

IN USE verify crew arrival

Precision check

A service-point count is not necessarily a count of individual people. The 420 figure describes the verified snapshot at 16:10. Do not turn it into a final impact total or silently change the population being counted.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

dispatch

Coordination and direction of resources or operating activity.

IN USE contact dispatch

outage management system (OMS)

A system supporting outage tracking, analysis, and response coordination.

IN USE update the outage management system

supervisory control and data acquisition (SCADA)

Systems used to monitor and control relevant industrial processes.

IN USE interpret SCADA information

telemetry

Measurements or status information transmitted from remote equipment.

IN USE verify telemetry status

load

Electrical demand placed on the system or equipment.

IN USE monitor system load

peak demand

The highest demand over a specified period and measurement basis.

IN USE assess peak demand

kilowatt (kW)

A unit of power equal to one thousand watts.

IN USE state demand in kilowatts

kilowatt-hour (kWh)

A unit of energy equal to one kilowatt sustained for one hour.

IN USE measure energy in kilowatt-hours

restoration sequence

The authorized order of activities or service recovery during restoration.

IN USE communicate the restoration sequence

status snapshot

A report of conditions as known at a stated time.

IN USE timestamp the status snapshot

planning assumption

An unverified condition or estimate used in developing a plan.

IN USE label a planning assumption

update commitment

A promise to provide new status information at a specified point.

IN USE keep the update commitment

Precision check

The 16:40 commitment concerns information. It is not a crew-arrival or restoration time. Also, a customer outage report does not establish that equipment is electrically safe; operational status requires authorized verification.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

TIMESTAMP THE MESSAGE

"This is the verified status as of 16:10 local time."

LIMIT THE COUNT

"That is the current snapshot, not a final impact total."

SEPARATE THE ESTIMATE

"A restoration estimate is not yet available."

EXPLAIN THE SOURCE

"That figure was an unverified planning assumption."

NAME THE SCOPE

"The update lists 420 affected service points in the Oak district."

STATE THE ASSESSMENT

"The cause remains under assessment."

CORRECT UNSUPPORTED CERTAINTY

"We cannot publish 18:00 as a confirmed restoration time."

DESCRIBE CREW STATUS

"A crew is assigned; arrival is not yet confirmed."

As of

Connects a count or status to its timestamp.

Affected service points

Names the measured unit without equating it to individual people.

Assigned versus arrived

Separates allocation from physical arrival.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

MAKE A CLEAR COMMITMENT

"Our next status update will be at 16:40 local time."

ACKNOWLEDGE DISRUPTION

"I understand that the uncertainty makes planning difficult."

COORDINATE THE CHANNELS

"Correct the website and customer-service message together."

MAINTAIN CONTACT

"We will update you even if the estimate remains unavailable."

PRESERVE THE DISTINCTION

"The update time is not a promise of restored service."

AVOID A GUESSED CAUSE

"We will not name a cause before it is verified."

KEEP THE CLOCK BASIS

"Use local time consistently in the public update."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Share the confirmed facts and the questions still under assessment."

Not yet available

Preserves uncertainty without implying that no work is happening.

By 18:00

Creates a latest-time promise that is unsupported here.

Next update

Identifies a communication commitment, not an operational outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which public update matches the record?

- A** Crews have arrived everywhere; repair is complete.
- B** The cause is known because a crew is assigned.
- C** At 16:10, 420 service points are affected; restoration timing is under assessment; next update 16:40.
- D** All 420 people will have power at 18:00.

2. Which phrase wrongly strengthens the crew status?

- A** Crews are on site.
- B** A crew is assigned.
- C** Arrival is unconfirmed.
- D** We are checking the arrival status.

3. What should happen if no estimate exists at 16:40?

- A** Cancel all communication without explanation.
- B** Invent a restoration time to meet the commitment.
- C** Repeat 18:00 as if it had been verified.
- D** Provide the promised update and state that timing remains under assessment.

4. What does the 420 figure count?

- A** Service points in the verified snapshot
- B** Every person experiencing disruption
- C** Every network asset needing replacement
- D** The guaranteed final number affected

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

An update time is not a restoration promise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

outage footprint / crew assignment / Damage assessment / update commitment / estimated restoration time / outage management system / status snapshot / planning assumption / crew arrival / restoration sequence

- 01 **Nia:** The draft promises restoration by eighteen hundred. Before publishing, can you confirm that time's source and whether it is verified?
- 02 **Paul:** It is a ¹ _____, not a confirmed estimate. Remove the promise. As of sixteen ten local time, operations still has the cause and restoration timing under assessment.
- 03 **Nia:** What can I say confidently? The draft also mentions the Oak district and four hundred twenty affected service points, but I want the exact scope.
- 04 **Paul:** Those are the verified figures in the ² _____. Keep the timestamp attached. The number may change as information improves, and it is not a count of individual people.
- 05 **Nia:** I will retain service points rather than replace that with residents. Customers also want to know whether anybody is working on the problem right now.
- 06 **Paul:** We can confirm the ³ _____. Arrival has not been verified, so do not say crews are on site. Assignment and physical arrival are different stages in the response.
- 07 **Nia:** That matters to customer service. Callers could ask why the message says someone is there when we cannot confirm it.
- 08 **Paul:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ supports tracking, but we still need to communicate the actual verified status. A populated field does not justify a stronger statement than its source.
- 09 **Nia:** Can we at least promise another update? Saying the estimate is unavailable without a next contact point sounds as though we have nothing further to offer.
- 10 **Paul:** Yes. Make an ⁵ _____ for sixteen forty local time. I will provide the verified position then, even if the restoration estimate remains unavailable and we need to say so.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Nia:** I will put the update time on its own line and label it clearly. It must not look like a deadline for the lights to come back on.
- 12 **Paul:** Keep it separate from ⁶ _____. Customers may scan only the number. The label must make clear that sixteen forty is our next communication, not an expected restoration or crew arrival.
- 13 **Nia:** The draft also guesses that a failed transformer caused the outage. Our record does not verify that cause.
- 14 **Paul:** Remove that diagnosis. ⁷ _____ and other relevant checks remain with qualified operations personnel. We should not turn a plausible equipment explanation into a finding because it sounds more informative.
- 15 **Nia:** I will correct the website and customer-service script together. Leaving the eighteen hundred promise in either channel would continue the confusion.
- 16 **Paul:** Agreed. Describe the ⁸ _____ consistently as well. We have a verified Oak district snapshot, not evidence that every nearby district or every person in that area is affected.
- 17 **Nia:** A service outage does not mean electrical equipment is safe. We must not let the public message imply an operational clearance.
- 18 **Paul:** Preserve that boundary without improvising instructions. The ⁹ _____ and equipment safety remain governed by authorized procedures. This message reports customer-service status; it does not authorize anyone to approach or operate equipment.
- 19 **Nia:** The revised message will give the timestamp, affected service points, unresolved cause and timing, assigned crew with arrival unconfirmed, and the sixteen forty update.
- 20 **Paul:** That is accurate. If ¹⁰ _____ or restoration information is confirmed before the next update, we can communicate the verified change. Until then, keep the difference between known status and expectation visible.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. planning assumption | 2. status snapshot | 3. crew assignment | 4. outage management system | 5. update commitment | 6. estimated restoration time | 7. Damage assessment | 8. outage footprint | 9. restoration sequence | 10. crew arrival

Correct a second outage message

F Say it

At 09:20 local time, 180 service points are affected in Pine district. Restoration timing is under assessment. The next information update is 09:50.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Pine / 09:50 / assessment / 180

Officer: "The verified affected count is ¹ _____ service points."

Liaison: "The affected district is ² _____."

Officer: "The next information update is at ³ _____."

Liaison: "Restoration timing remains under ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. 180 | 2. Pine | 3. 09:50 | 4. assessment

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two identifiers must not be treated as interchangeable

A Read the situation

Escalate conflicting equipment references and use exact repeat-back without creating an operational instruction.

A fictional field work package identifies equipment Q27, while its associated switching request identifies Q72. The team has not established which identifier is correct. Field lead Luis has placed the affected task on hold under the local process; no operational action is authorized from these conflicting documents. System operator Farah will coordinate reconciliation through the authorized document and operating procedures. Neither identifier is to be silently corrected, and neither the equipment state nor a safe work condition can be inferred from this dialogue. The language task is to communicate the discrepancy, hold, owner, and next review accurately.

PEOPLE / Luis: Field lead | Farah: System operator

EXACT REPETITION CAN PREVENT A DANGEROUS ASSUMPTION

Similar numbers can sound like a small administrative mistake. Treat the discrepancy as unresolved until the authorized process establishes the correct reference. A respectful repeat-back confirms the message; it does not verify the physical asset or authorize work.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which identifiers conflict?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Two approved replacement instructions | B Q27 and Q72 |
| C Q27 and Q27 | D Two confirmed names for the same asset |

2. Which identifier is correct from the supplied facts?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A Q72 because it sounds more familiar | B Both, because the digits match |
| C It has not been established. | D Q27 because it appears first |

3. What does a repeat-back establish?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A That equipment is deenergized | B That a switching action is authorized |
| C That the physical asset has been verified | D That the discrepancy and current hold were understood |

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

equipment identifier

The exact reference used to identify a particular item of equipment.

IN USE verify the equipment identifier

asset tag

A label or code assigned to an asset for identification.

IN USE reconcile the asset tag

work package

The documents and information governing a defined work task.

IN USE review the work package

switching request

A request for specified switching activity through the authorized process.

IN USE check the switching request

switching order

An authorized sequence or instruction for switching under the applicable process.

IN USE verify the switching order

single-line diagram

A simplified diagram representing electrical connections with single lines.

IN USE consult the current single-line diagram

system operator

An authorized person responsible for specified system-operating functions.

IN USE contact the system operator

field lead

The person leading the relevant field team or task.

IN USE notify the field lead

energized

Connected to an electrical energy source or otherwise carrying electrical potential as applicable.

IN USE verify energized status

deenergized

In the required state established through applicable hazardous-energy procedures.

IN USE establish deenergized status

isolation

Separation from relevant energy sources under the applicable authorized process.

IN USE verify isolation requirements

backfeed

Electrical energy supplied from an unexpected or alternative direction or source.

IN USE assess backfeed hazards

Precision check

Q27 and Q72 contain the same digits in a different order. That resemblance does not prove a harmless typo or identify the correct asset. Keep both references intact in the discrepancy report until authorized reconciliation is complete.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

grounding

Establishing the required electrical connection to ground under applicable procedures.

IN USE follow authorized grounding requirements

induced voltage

Voltage produced by electromagnetic influence from another source.

IN USE assess induced-voltage hazards

arc flash

A hazardous release of energy associated with an electrical arc.

IN USE assess arc-flash hazards

minimum approach distance

A required separation from electrical hazards under applicable conditions and rules.

IN USE observe the applicable minimum approach distance

qualified worker

A worker with the required training and competence for the specified task.

IN USE verify qualified-worker status

operating authority

The assigned authority to make or direct specified operational decisions.

IN USE preserve operating authority

clearance

A formal authorization or controlled status with a defined meaning under the operating procedure.

IN USE verify the clearance conditions

lockout/tagout

Procedures using locks and tags within the applicable hazardous-energy control process.

IN USE follow applicable lockout/tagout procedures

read-back

Repetition of a received message to check its accuracy.

IN USE perform an exact read-back

hold point

A boundary beyond which the affected activity must not proceed until requirements are met.

IN USE maintain the hold point

document reconciliation

Resolving conflicting information through the authorized review and record process.

IN USE complete document reconciliation

revision control

Management of document versions and their applicable status.

IN USE maintain revision control

Precision check

Read-back confirms what was communicated. It does not establish equipment identity, isolation, deenergized status, or authorization. No operation, testing sequence, distance, or protective-equipment selection is taught by this dialogue.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE DISCREPANCY

"The work package says Q27; the switching request says Q72."

AVOID CHOOSING BY APPEARANCE

"We have not established which identifier is correct."

CONTRAST THE OTHER REFERENCE

"The switching request reads Q seven two."

NAME THE REVIEW OWNER

"Farah will coordinate the authorized reconciliation."

KEEP THE HOLD EXPLICIT

"The affected task remains on hold."

REPEAT THE DIGITS

"I read Q two seven in the work package."

PRESERVE THE DOCUMENTS

"Do not silently change either reference."

KEEP AUTHORITY SEPARATE

"This conversation does not authorize an operational action."

Two seven versus seven two

Read each digit distinctly to expose the mismatch.

Which is correct

An unresolved question, not an invitation to guess.

Remain

Preserves the existing hold instead of implying a new permission.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK RECEIPT

"Please read back the discrepancy and task status."

AVOID A STATE ASSUMPTION

"We cannot infer the equipment's electrical state from these labels."

MAINTAIN ROLE BOUNDARIES

"Only the relevant authorized personnel can change the operating status."

STATE THE NEXT CONDITION

"The conflict must be resolved through the required process."

LIMIT THE REPEAT-BACK

"That confirms the message, not the physical asset."

CHECK THE APPLICABLE ISSUE

"Reconcile the current documents through revision control."

AVOID AN IMPROVISED SHORTCUT

"Familiarity with the site is not a substitute for verification."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"Keep the task on hold until the applicable requirements and authorization are satisfied."

Coordinate

Describes responsibility for review, not automatic approval.

Does not authorize

Keeps a communication exercise outside operational instruction.

Current

Must be established through revision control, not assumed from a file name.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message preserves the discrepancy?

- A** Q27 is correct because it was typed first.
- B** Q72 is correct because the numbers look familiar.
- C** Both references mean the same equipment, so proceed.
- D** Work package Q27; switching request Q72; correct reference unresolved; task on hold.

2. What should happen to the conflicting records?

- A** Quietly edit one until both match.
- B** Delete the less convenient reference.
- C** Replace both with a guessed asset name.
- D** Preserve them and use the authorized reconciliation process.

3. Which conclusion is not supported by a read-back?

- A** The listener knows who coordinates the review.
- B** The equipment is safe to work on.
- C** The listener heard Q27 and Q72.
- D** The listener understood the task is on hold.

4. Which response to schedule pressure is appropriate?

- A** Proceed using whichever asset is closer.
- B** Assume a familiar label removes the conflict.
- C** Use the dialogue as the switching instruction.
- D** The identifier conflict remains unresolved; the task stays on hold under the local process.

Answers and explanations: [page 78](#).

Two identifiers must not be treated as interchangeable

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

switching request / Operating authority / system operator / hold point / deenergized / equipment identifier / document reconciliation / revision control / read-back / work package

- 01 **Luis:** The affected task is on hold. Our work package identifies Q two seven, but the switching request identifies Q seven two. We have not established the correct reference.
- 02 **Farah:** I have the ¹ _____ discrepancy. Keep both references exactly as recorded while I coordinate the authorized review. This conversation does not authorize any operational action.
- 03 **Luis:** A colleague thinks the digits were simply transposed and wants to correct the request. That may be plausible, but we do not have a verified basis.
- 04 **Farah:** Do not substitute plausibility for ² _____. We need the applicable process to establish the correct information and its relationship to the physical asset, not merely make two documents look consistent.
- 05 **Luis:** I will preserve both documents and report the mismatch. The team knows the site well, but familiarity does not tell us which record is wrong.
- 06 **Farah:** Correct. The ³ _____ may contain the error, or the associated request may. We must not give either one automatic priority just because it was the first document someone read.
- 07 **Luis:** Let me read the distinction again: Q two seven in the package; Q seven two in the request. The affected task remains on hold.
- 08 **Farah:** That ⁴ _____ confirms the message accurately. It does not verify the physical equipment, establish its electrical state, or satisfy the separate requirements for an authorized operating decision.
- 09 **Luis:** The crew needs that distinction explicitly. Someone might otherwise interpret your acknowledgement as confirmation that the task can proceed.
- 10 **Farah:** Keep the ⁵ _____ visible in the handover. My acknowledgement means I received the discrepancy. It is not a release, a clearance, or an instruction to perform switching.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Luis:** Should I label the equipment deenergized? The public outage map shows customers without supply nearby, but that is a different source.
- 12 **Farah:** Do not infer ⁶ _____ status from an outage map or these records. The applicable hazardous-energy procedures and qualified verification govern that determination, not a communications summary.
- 13 **Luis:** I will leave the equipment state unconfirmed. We need to communicate the document problem, not create our own technical work sequence.
- 14 **Farah:** Exactly. ⁷ _____ remains with the relevant authorized personnel under the actual procedures. Neither our discussion nor a corrected label alone establishes every condition required for the work.
- 15 **Luis:** Who coordinates the next review? The incoming lead needs a named contact and a clear statement that the discrepancy remains unresolved.
- 16 **Farah:** I will coordinate it as the ⁸ _____ for this exchange, through the authorized process. Keep the current hold and unresolved reference in the handover, and identify any later verified decision by its record.
- 17 **Luis:** If a revised document arrives, we should also check that it is the applicable issue. A new file name by itself will not tell us that.
- 18 **Farah:** Use the required ⁹ _____ process. The relevant records must be reconciled and distributed correctly, with any operational authorization handled under its own requirements rather than implied by an attachment.
- 19 **Luis:** My summary is Q27 in the package, Q72 in the request, correct identifier unresolved, task on hold, and you coordinating the authorized review.
- 20 **Farah:** That is the right boundary. A ¹⁰ _____ is not permission to improvise an operation. Keep the discrepancy and hold explicit until the actual procedure establishes the information and authorization required.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. equipment identifier | 2. document reconciliation | 3. work package | 4. read-back | 5. hold point | 6. deenergized | 7. Operating authority | 8. system operator | 9. revision control | 10. switching request

Read back another identifier conflict

F Say it

A work package says R18; its associated request says R81. The correct reference is unresolved. Coordinator Ema owns the review, and the affected task remains on hold.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Ema / R18 / R81 / hold

Lead: "The work package identifies ¹ _____."

Operator: "The associated request identifies ² _____."

Lead: "The review coordinator is ³ _____."

Operator: "The affected task remains on ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. R18 | 2. R81 | 3. Ema | 4. hold

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A proposed rate is mistaken for the current bill

A Read the situation

Explain a rate proposal and calculate a conditional bill example without implying approval.

A fictional notice proposes increasing an energy charge from \$0.10 to \$0.105 per kWh, a 5% increase in that component. The monthly fixed charge would remain \$20. The proposal is under review; neither approval nor an effective date is established. Customer adviser Hana uses a simplified 500 kWh monthly example with no taxes, credits, or other charges. At the current rates the example totals \$70; under the proposal it would total \$72.50 at the same usage. Customer Mr Diaz assumes his entire bill has already risen 5%. His actual account has not been reviewed.

PEOPLE / Hana: Customer adviser | Mr Diaz: Customer

EXPLAIN THE NUMBER THE CUSTOMER WILL ACTUALLY INTERPRET

A notice may accurately describe a percentage change in one component while a reader hears a change in the whole bill. Identify the component first, then show the conditional total. Do not dismiss the misunderstanding as a failure to read carefully.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the proposal's current status?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Already effective for every customer | B Rejected permanently |
| C Applied only because a notice was mailed | D Under review, with no approval or effective date established |

2. What does the 5% figure describe?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The increase in every total bill | B The change in monthly usage |
| C An increase in the fixed charge | D The energy-charge rate increase from \$0.10 to \$0.105 per kWh |

3. What is the current simplified bill at 500 kWh?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| A \$72.50 | B \$73.50 |
| C \$70 | D \$50 |

Answers and explanations: page 80.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

tariff

The applicable schedule of rates, terms, and conditions for service.

IN USE consult the current tariff

rate case

A regulatory proceeding concerning utility revenues, rates, or their allocation.

IN USE explain the rate case

public utilities commission

A regulatory body overseeing specified utility matters in its jurisdiction.

IN USE identify the public utilities commission

revenue requirement

The revenue amount considered necessary under the applicable regulatory determination.

IN USE review the revenue requirement

cost of service

Costs allocated to providing utility service under the relevant analysis.

IN USE assess cost of service

rate base

The investment value used in the applicable regulatory return calculation.

IN USE determine the rate base

rate of return

The return rate considered or allowed on the relevant investment basis.

IN USE explain the rate of return

customer class

A grouping of customers used for service or rate treatment.

IN USE identify the customer class

fixed charge

A charge not directly varying with the measured usage in the stated example.

IN USE distinguish the fixed charge

volumetric charge

A charge based on the quantity consumed or delivered.

IN USE calculate the volumetric charge

demand charge

A charge based on measured or specified demand under the applicable tariff.

IN USE explain a demand charge

ratepayer

A customer paying the regulated utility's rates.

IN USE communicate with ratepayers

Precision check

The example energy charge rises from \$50 to \$52.50. With the unchanged \$20 fixed charge, the total rises from \$70 to \$72.50: \$2.50, or about 3.57%, not 5%. All proposed figures are conditional.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

filing

A formal submission to the relevant authority or proceeding.

IN USE review a regulatory filing

docket

The official record or identifier for a proceeding.

IN USE locate the docket

hearing

A formal session for evidence, argument, or public participation.

IN USE attend a regulatory hearing

effective date

The date on which an approved or applicable provision begins to operate.

IN USE verify the effective date

proposed rate

A rate submitted for consideration rather than established as current.

IN USE distinguish the proposed rate

approved rate

A rate accepted through the relevant regulatory process.

IN USE verify the approved rate

bill impact

The effect of rates and usage on a customer's total charge.

IN USE illustrate the bill impact

test year

A period used as a basis for the relevant rate-case analysis.

IN USE identify the test year

rate design

The structure by which charges are assigned and recovered from customers.

IN USE explain the rate design

rate rider

A separate adjustment or provision attached to the relevant rate structure.

IN USE identify a rate rider

intervenor

A party participating in a proceeding under its applicable rules.

IN USE identify an intervenor

usage assumption

The stated consumption level used in a calculation or example.

IN USE state the usage assumption

Precision check

The example holds usage at 500 kWh and excludes other charges. It does not predict the actual bill for Mr Diaz. A rate proposal, an approved rate, and a rate in effect are different statuses that must remain distinct.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

NAME THE STATUS FIRST

"The notice describes a proposal that is still under review."

IDENTIFY THE COMPONENT

"The five percent refers to the energy-charge rate."

STATE THE PROPOSED RATE

"The proposed rate is ten and a half cents per kilowatt-hour."

GIVE THE USAGE BASIS

"This example holds monthly usage at five hundred kilowatt-hours."

AVOID IMPLIED APPROVAL

"No approval or effective date is established in this case."

STATE THE CURRENT RATE

"The current example rate is ten cents per kilowatt-hour."

KEEP THE FIXED CHARGE

"The monthly twenty-dollar fixed charge would remain unchanged."

CALCULATE THE CURRENT COMPONENT

"The current energy charge is fifty dollars."

Would

Keeps proposed charges conditional rather than current.

Per kilowatt-hour

Identifies the usage-based unit in the rate.

At the same usage

Prevents a rate comparison from silently changing consumption.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CALCULATE THE PROPOSED COMPONENT

"Under the proposal, the energy charge would be fifty-two dollars fifty."

DISTINGUISH PERCENTAGE BASES

"That is about a 3.57 percent increase in this example total."

LIMIT THE ILLUSTRATION

"Taxes, credits, and other charges are excluded from this simplified example."

OFFER THE RELEVANT RECORD

"The official notice and proceeding record show the proposal's status."

ADD THE COMPONENTS

"The example total would move from seventy dollars to seventy-two dollars fifty."

PRESERVE THE CONDITION

"These figures apply only if the proposal is approved as described."

AVOID ACCOUNT ASSUMPTIONS

"We have not reviewed your actual account or usage."

CLOSE WITH A CHECK

"The proposal changes one rate component, not every bill by the same percentage."

Percentage of what

Identifies the denominator behind a percentage claim.

In this example

Limits the calculation to its supplied charges and assumptions.

Under review

Neither approved nor necessarily rejected.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. What would the proposed energy charge be at 500 kWh?

- A** \$72.50
- B** \$105
- C** \$52.50
- D** \$50

2. What would the simplified total be?

- A** \$52.50
- B** \$73.50
- C** \$75
- D** \$72.50

3. Which percentage statement is accurate?

- A** The fixed charge rises 5%.
- B** Usage necessarily rises 5%.
- C** The energy rate rises 5%; this example total rises about 3.57%.
- D** Every total bill rises exactly 5%.

4. Which customer statement preserves the status?

- A** The proposal takes effect automatically when discussed.
- B** This is a conditional illustration, not an approved change to your account.
- C** Your bill has already risen because the notice was published.
- D** The example determines every future bill.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

A proposed rate is mistaken for the current bill

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

fixed charge / customer class / usage assumption / effective date / proposed rate / bill impact / volumetric charge / approved rate / rate design / docket

- 01 **Mr Diaz:** I received the notice about a five percent increase. Does that mean my whole electricity bill has already gone up by five percent this month?
- 02 **Hana:** The ¹ _____ is still under review. No approval or effective date is established here, so the notice does not mean this change has already reached your bill.
- 03 **Mr Diaz:** I still want to understand the five percent figure. The notice has several numbers, and I assumed that percentage described my total.
- 04 **Hana:** It describes the ² _____ rate, from ten cents to ten and a half cents per kilowatt-hour. The separate monthly fixed charge would remain twenty dollars.
- 05 **Mr Diaz:** Could you show a simple example of how the energy rate combines with the other charge on a bill?
- 06 **Hana:** Let's use a ³ _____ of five hundred kilowatt-hours for the month. We will hold that constant and exclude taxes, credits, and other charges so the comparison is clear.
- 07 **Mr Diaz:** At ten cents for each of five hundred kilowatt-hours, the current energy part is fifty dollars. Then I still add the twenty-dollar monthly charge.
- 08 **Hana:** Correct. Including the ⁴ _____, the current example totals seventy dollars. Under the proposal, the energy part would be fifty-two dollars fifty, before that same twenty dollars.
- 09 **Mr Diaz:** So the proposed example total would be seventy-two dollars fifty. That is two dollars fifty more than seventy, not five percent of the whole amount.
- 10 **Hana:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ in this illustration is about three point five seven percent. The energy rate rises five percent, but the unchanged fixed charge makes the total's percentage different.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Mr Diaz:** If my household uses a different amount, the illustration may not match my actual bill. Other charges or credits could change the comparison as well.
- 12 **Hana:** Yes. Your ⁶ _____ and actual applicable terms also matter. We have not reviewed your account, so I should not present this simplified calculation as your personal bill forecast.
- 13 **Mr Diaz:** Where can I see whether the proposal changes or is accepted? I would prefer the official information rather than a social-media summary of the notice.
- 14 **Hana:** The official notice and ⁷ _____ provide the relevant proceeding information. Follow the stated official channels; this fictional example does not supply a real filing number or a participation deadline.
- 15 **Mr Diaz:** And if a decision is eventually issued, I should still check what it actually approves rather than assume every part of the original request was accepted.
- 16 **Hana:** Correct. An ⁸ _____ may differ from what was proposed. The decision and applicable tariff information determine the resulting terms, not the version of the notice first circulated.
- 17 **Mr Diaz:** I should distinguish approval from when a change begins, and read the actual terms rather than infer timing from publication.
- 18 **Hana:** Check the ⁹ _____ rather than infer one. Here, neither approval nor that date is established, so the proposed numbers remain conditional throughout our explanation.
- 19 **Mr Diaz:** I can now explain it accurately: a five percent proposal for one energy-rate component, with a different percentage effect on the simplified total, and no approved change yet.
- 20 **Hana:** That captures the ¹⁰ _____ distinction. Keep the usage and exclusions beside the example, and use would rather than has when describing the proposal's possible effect.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. proposed rate | 2. volumetric charge | 3. usage assumption | 4. fixed charge | 5. bill impact | 6. customer class | 7. docket | 8. approved rate | 9. effective date | 10. rate design

Calculate another conditional example

F Say it

At 400 kWh, a simplified current bill uses \$0.10 per kWh plus a \$20 fixed charge. An unapproved proposal would change the energy rate to \$0.105. Other charges are excluded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unapproved / 42 / 60 / 62

Adviser: "The current total is \$¹ _____."

Customer: "The proposed energy component would be \$² _____."

Adviser: "The proposed total would be \$³ _____."

Customer: "The proposal remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. 60 | 2. 42 | 3. 62 | 4. unapproved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

In the queue does not mean connected

A Read the situation

04

Explain renewable-project review status without confusing capacity, application progress, and operating permission.

A fictional 120 kW rooftop solar project has submitted interconnection application Q314 and received an acknowledgement. It is in the review queue, but inverter data remain incomplete and the metering review is open. No connection approval, permission to operate, confirmed upgrade cost, or operating date has been issued. Developer Elena finds a presentation saying connection secured. Utility coordinator Amir must help replace that claim with the actual status. The 120 kW figure is proposed nameplate power, not annual energy output or a guaranteed export allowance. Applicable utility and jurisdictional requirements govern the real process.

PEOPLE / Elena: Project developer | Amir: Utility interconnection coordinator

A MILESTONE LABEL CAN OUTFRAN THE EVIDENCE

A project team may shorten a long status into secured to sound decisive. State the completed administrative step and the open technical questions separately. This allows a positive report of progress without implying a permission or commercial certainty that does not exist.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What has the project received?

A A final upgrade invoice

C Permission to operate

B An acknowledgement of application Q314

D A guaranteed export allowance

2. What does 120 kW describe?

A Proposed nameplate power

C A confirmed export entitlement

B Annual energy in kWh

D The approved upgrade price

3. Which status is supported?

A Every technical review passed

C Application acknowledged; inverter data incomplete; metering review open

B No application exists

D Connection secured with a fixed operating date

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

interconnection

The arrangement and process for connecting a generating resource to an electrical network.

IN USE review the interconnection

distributed energy resource (DER)

A generation, storage, or controllable resource connected at the distribution or customer level.

IN USE assess a distributed energy resource

photovoltaic (PV)

Relating to conversion of sunlight into electricity.

IN USE develop a photovoltaic project

nameplate capacity

The rated power capacity stated for equipment or a system on its specified basis.

IN USE state nameplate capacity

inverter

Equipment converting direct-current electricity to alternating-current electricity in the relevant application.

IN USE submit inverter data

application acknowledgement

Confirmation that a submitted application has been received.

IN USE distinguish application acknowledgement

review queue

The sequence or grouping of applications awaiting relevant review.

IN USE track the review queue

queue position

The application's place under the applicable queue rules.

IN USE confirm queue position

feasibility study

A preliminary assessment of whether and under what conditions a proposed connection may be feasible.

IN USE review a feasibility study

system impact study

Analysis of a proposed connection's effects on the electrical system.

IN USE assess the system impact study

facilities study

Review of the facilities and associated work needed for a proposed connection.

IN USE review the facilities study

hosting capacity

The ability of a network area to accommodate additional resources under defined conditions.

IN USE assess hosting capacity

Precision check

Kilowatts describe power; kilowatt-hours describe energy over time. Proposed nameplate power does not establish annual output, hosting capacity, approved export, or permission to operate. Each needs its own basis and, where relevant, decision.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

export limit

A limit on the power a resource may send to the network under applicable terms.

IN USE verify the export limit

non-export arrangement

An arrangement intended to prevent export to the network under its specified controls and terms.

IN USE review a non-export arrangement

protection settings

Parameters governing relevant protective equipment behavior.

IN USE verify protection settings

metering arrangement

The equipment and terms used to measure relevant flows or usage.

IN USE confirm the metering arrangement

network upgrade

A change to network facilities required or proposed for a connection or other need.

IN USE assess network upgrades

cost allocation

Assignment of costs to the relevant parties under the applicable basis.

IN USE clarify cost allocation

interconnection agreement

The applicable agreement defining the terms of a connection.

IN USE review the interconnection agreement

permission to operate (PTO)

The required authorization to operate under the relevant utility process.

IN USE verify permission to operate

commissioning

Verification and documentation of installed-system performance under the relevant process.

IN USE coordinate commissioning

curtailment

Reduction of output below otherwise available generation under specified conditions.

IN USE explain curtailment risk

power quality

Characteristics of electrical supply or output relevant to acceptable performance.

IN USE assess power quality

reactive power

Power associated with alternating-current energy exchange in inductive or capacitive elements.

IN USE assess reactive-power requirements

Precision check

An acknowledgement records receipt. A queue position describes an administrative status under applicable rules. Neither supplies the missing inverter data, closes metering review, fixes upgrade costs, or authorizes operation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

REPORT THE COMPLETED STEP

"Application Q314 has been submitted and acknowledged."

CORRECT THE SLIDE

"Connection secured overstates the current status."

NAME THE SECOND OPEN ITEM

"The metering review is still open."

DEFINE THE CAPACITY FIGURE

"The 120 kW figure is proposed nameplate power."

STATE THE CURRENT STAGE

"The application is in the review queue."

NAME THE FIRST OPEN ITEM

"Inverter data remain incomplete."

SEPARATE OPERATING PERMISSION

"No permission to operate has been issued."

AVOID AN ENERGY CLAIM

"It is not annual energy output in kilowatt-hours."

Acknowledged

Means received, not technically approved.

Secured

Can imply a completed right or commitment and is too strong here.

Remain incomplete

Identifies an unresolved information gap.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN EXPORT ASSUMPTION

"Nameplate capacity does not establish the permitted export limit."

PRESERVE TIMING UNCERTAINTY

"No operating date has been issued."

LIMIT QUEUE LANGUAGE

"Queue status does not itself reserve an approved connection."

AVOID AUTOMATIC COMPLETION

"Supplying one missing document does not close every review."

KEEP COSTS QUALIFIED

"Upgrade costs and their allocation are not confirmed."

ASK FOR THE APPLICABLE ROUTE

"Which current utility requirements govern this application?"

COORDINATE THE MISSING INPUT

"We will submit the required inverter information for review."

CLOSE WITH SEPARATE STATUSES

"Report receipt, technical review, commercial terms, and operating permission separately."

Nameplate

Describes rated power on its stated basis, not actual energy production.

Not confirmed

Preserves uncertainty about cost or timing.

Separately

Prevents one completed step from being used as evidence for unrelated approvals.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which presentation line is accurate?

- A** Connection secured because the acknowledgement arrived
- B** Annual output guaranteed at 120 kW
- C** Export rights confirmed by the proposed nameplate rating
- D** Q314 acknowledged; technical reviews open; no operating permission issued

2. Which unit measures energy rather than power?

- A** A rate-case docket
- B** kWh
- C** kW
- D** A queue number

3. What follows from submitting the missing inverter data?

- A** That input can be reviewed; other requirements remain separate.
- B** Every review automatically closes.
- C** The system can operate immediately.
- D** Upgrade costs become zero.

4. Which statement about costs is supported?

- A** All upgrades are free because the system is rooftop solar.
- B** The application number is the upgrade price.
- C** Acknowledgement makes the developer's budget binding on the utility.
- D** Upgrade costs and allocation remain unconfirmed.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

In the queue does not mean connected

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

metering arrangement / network upgrades / nameplate capacity / cost allocation / permission to operate / application acknowledgement / export limit / inverter / interconnection agreement / review queue

- 01 **Elena:** The presentation says connection secured. We have an acknowledgement for Q314, but is that heading too strong?
- 02 **Amir:** It is. The ¹ _____ confirms receipt, not approval. Inverter data remain incomplete, the metering review is open, and no permission to operate has been issued.
- 03 **Elena:** Can I describe our queue status as capacity reserved, or would that imply a commitment the record does not establish?
- 04 **Amir:** Describe the ² _____ status accurately. We have no basis here to claim reserved capacity, an approved export allowance, or a completed connection decision from that administrative step.
- 05 **Elena:** I will replace secured with application submitted and acknowledged, technical review ongoing. What should I say about the 120 kW figure beside the project name?
- 06 **Amir:** Label it proposed ³ _____. It describes power on its stated rating basis. It is not annual energy output, which would use kilowatt-hours, and it does not establish actual generation.
- 07 **Elena:** That prevents someone converting the rating into guaranteed annual output without checking operating conditions. We have no such estimate here.
- 08 **Amir:** Correct. Nor does the figure establish an ⁴ _____. The permitted operating arrangement depends on the applicable review and terms, not simply the size written on the proposed equipment.
- 09 **Elena:** The technical team is preparing the missing inverter information. I can give them the action, but I should not promise that supplying it completes every review.
- 10 **Amir:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ data are one open input. The metering review remains separate, and other applicable requirements still need their own verified status under the actual utility process.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Elena:** The investor slide also shows our internal operating target. We have no confirmation that the required reviews will finish by then.
- 12 **Amir:** Mark it as an internal target, not ⁶ _____ or a confirmed date. In this case, no operating date has been issued, and no one should interpret the slide as authorization to energize or operate.
- 13 **Elena:** We should remove the claim that upgrades will cost nothing as well. I do not see any verified study or cost decision supporting that assumption.
- 14 **Amir:** Yes. Potential ⁷ _____ and their costs remain unconfirmed here. An application acknowledgement does not determine whether upgrades are needed or which party would pay for them.
- 15 **Elena:** I will separate the engineering questions from the commercial ones. A technical answer might identify work, but the responsibility for its cost still needs its own basis.
- 16 **Amir:** That is the ⁸ _____ distinction. Use the applicable rules and agreements rather than assume that a rooftop project, a queue position, or a proposed budget settles responsibility.
- 17 **Elena:** Can we describe the next step positively? I want to show real progress while making the remaining questions specific.
- 18 **Amir:** Say the team is submitting the missing data for review while the ⁹ _____ is being assessed. That is concrete progress, with the open items visible, and does not imply that either review has reached a favorable decision.
- 19 **Elena:** My revised slide will distinguish proposed power, acknowledged application, open technical items, unconfirmed costs and timing, and the absence of operating permission.
- 20 **Amir:** Good. The eventual ¹⁰ _____ and required operating authorizations each need their actual status reported. Do not let a short heading collapse all those stages into one unsupported claim.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. application acknowledgement | 2. review queue | 3. nameplate capacity | 4. export limit | 5. inverter | 6. permission to operate | 7. network upgrades | 8. cost allocation | 9. metering arrangement | 10. interconnection agreement

Report another application stage

F Say it

A proposed 75 kW project has acknowledgement for application Z206. Metering review is open, and no permission to operate is issued.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Z206 / open / 75 / unissued

Developer: "The application reference is ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "The proposed nameplate power is ² _____ kW."

Developer: "Metering review remains ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Permission to operate is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. Z206 | 2. 75 | 3. open | 4. unissued

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The cheapest purchase is not the cheapest comparison

A Read the situation

Compare a stated cost basis, test an assumption, and keep the purchase decision separate from partial arithmetic.

Two fictional asset options are compared over ten years. Option A costs \$10,000 to purchase and \$2,000 per year in maintenance. Option B costs \$14,000 to purchase and \$1,000 per year in maintenance. The exercise uses constant annual amounts and no discounting. Installation, energy, downtime, disposal, residual value, and technical equivalence have not been assessed. Analyst Sam finds a slide calling A the lowest-cost choice because its purchase price is lower. Asset manager Priya requests a purchase-and-maintenance comparison, with its limits stated. Neither option is approved for purchase.

PEOPLE / Sam: Asset analyst | Priya: Asset manager

CHALLENGE THE COMPARISON, NOT THE BUDGET OWNER

A low initial price can be attractive when a team faces a tight annual budget. Show which costs the slide includes before challenging its conclusion. A transparent comparison lets colleagues discuss affordability and long-term cost as related but different questions.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Option A's ten-year purchase-and-maintenance total?

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| A \$20,000 | B \$10,000 |
| C \$30,000 | D \$12,000 |

2. What is Option B's corresponding total?

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| A \$14,000 | B \$30,000 |
| C \$24,000 | D \$15,000 |

3. What does the supplied comparison establish?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A All possible ownership costs are included. | B B is \$6,000 lower on this limited undiscounted basis. |
| C B is approved for purchase. | D A is technically inferior. |

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

asset management

Coordinating asset decisions across performance, risk, cost, and life.

IN USE develop an asset-management plan

purchase price

The amount paid to acquire an asset.

IN USE compare purchase prices

capital expenditure (CAPEX)

Spending on acquiring or improving long-lived assets under the applicable accounting treatment.

IN USE assess capital expenditure

operating expenditure (OPEX)

Costs of operating the business or assets under the relevant accounting treatment.

IN USE forecast operating expenditure

preventive maintenance

Planned maintenance intended to reduce failures or deterioration.

IN USE schedule preventive maintenance

corrective maintenance

Maintenance performed to address an identified fault or failure.

IN USE track corrective maintenance

condition-based maintenance

Maintenance guided by evidence of the actual asset condition.

IN USE evaluate condition-based maintenance

maintenance interval

The period or usage between planned maintenance actions.

IN USE review the maintenance interval

recurring cost

A cost expected to occur repeatedly over a period.

IN USE estimate recurring costs

assessment horizon

The period over which options are evaluated.

IN USE define the assessment horizon

life-cycle cost

Cost across the relevant stages of an asset's life on a defined basis.

IN USE assess life-cycle cost

total cost of ownership

The included acquisition, operation, maintenance, and other ownership costs over a stated period.

IN USE compare total cost of ownership

Precision check

A totals \$30,000 and B totals \$24,000 on the supplied purchase-and-maintenance basis. B is \$6,000 lower despite its \$4,000 higher purchase price. Neither number is a complete life-cycle estimate.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

downtime

Time during which an asset is unavailable for its intended service.

IN USE account for downtime

failure mode

A particular way an asset or component can fail.

IN USE assess a failure mode

asset criticality

The importance of an asset based on the consequences of its failure or unavailability.

IN USE assess asset criticality

remaining useful life

The estimated period of useful service still available from an asset.

IN USE estimate remaining useful life

replacement cycle

The timing or pattern used to replace assets.

IN USE plan the replacement cycle

residual value

The value remaining at the end of the assessment period.

IN USE estimate residual value

disposal cost

The cost of removing or disposing of an asset at the relevant stage.

IN USE include disposal costs

discounted cash flow

Evaluation of future cash flows using an explicit discount-rate basis.

IN USE distinguish discounted cash flow

sensitivity analysis

Testing how a result changes when an assumption changes.

IN USE run a sensitivity analysis

technical equivalence

Comparable ability to meet the specified technical requirements.

IN USE establish technical equivalence

cost boundary

The set of costs included or excluded from an analysis.

IN USE state the cost boundary

decision criteria

The factors used to assess and choose among alternatives.

IN USE agree decision criteria

Precision check

If B maintenance were \$1,600 per year instead, its ten-year total would be \$30,000, equal to A on this limited basis. That sensitivity result changes no technical finding and does not approve either purchase.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE NARROW COMPARISON

"The slide compares purchase prices only."

NAME THE HORIZON

"We are comparing ten years."

CALCULATE A

"Ten thousand plus ten times two thousand gives thirty thousand dollars."

STATE THE LIMITED RESULT

"B is six thousand dollars lower on this purchase-and-maintenance basis."

STATE THE HIGHER UPFRONT AMOUNT

"B costs four thousand dollars more to purchase."

EXPLAIN THE RECURRING COST

"A has two thousand dollars of annual maintenance."

CALCULATE B

"Fourteen thousand plus ten times one thousand gives twenty-four thousand dollars."

PRESERVE THE EXCLUSIONS

"Installation, energy, downtime, disposal, and residual value are excluded."

On this basis

Limits a result to the included costs and assumptions.

Upfront

Refers to the initial expenditure, not the total over time.

Per year

Must be multiplied by the stated number of years.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A BROAD LABEL

"This is not a complete life-cycle-cost comparison."

CHECK TECHNICAL SUITABILITY

"Technical equivalence remains unassessed."

STATE THE SENSITIVITY RESULT

"B would then total thirty thousand dollars over ten years."

AVOID AN APPROVAL CLAIM

"Neither option is approved for purchase."

NAME THE FINANCIAL ASSUMPTION

"The figures are undiscounted and use constant annual amounts."

TEST AN ASSUMPTION

"At sixteen hundred dollars a year, B's maintenance changes the comparison."

SEPARATE AFFORDABILITY

"A lower upfront price and a lower long-term total are different considerations."

CLOSE WITH THE DECISION BASIS

"Present the arithmetic, exclusions, and unresolved decision criteria together."

Undiscounted

Does not adjust future amounts to a present-value basis.

Would then

Marks an alternative assumption rather than the original estimate.

Unassessed

Keeps technical suitability separate from the cost calculation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Why is lowest-cost choice unsupported for A?

- A** A has no purchase price.
- B** Ten-year costs must always equal the initial payment.
- C** B has already been selected by engineering.
- D** It uses purchase price while ignoring the supplied recurring maintenance difference.

2. At \$1,600 annual maintenance, what would B total over ten years?

- A** \$15,600
- B** \$24,000
- C** \$30,000
- D** \$16,000

3. Which label fits the original calculation?

- A** Ten-year undiscounted purchase-and-maintenance comparison
- B** Complete discounted life-cycle cost
- C** Confirmed procurement approval
- D** Verified technical-equivalence assessment

4. What remains necessary before a full decision?

- A** Choose A automatically because its first payment is lower.
- B** Assume all omitted costs are zero.
- C** Assess omitted costs, technical suitability, and the relevant decision criteria.
- D** Choose B automatically because one subtotal is lower.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The cheapest purchase is not the cheapest comparison

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

discounted cash flow / Total cost of ownership / purchase price / Technical equivalence / cost boundary / assessment horizon / sensitivity analysis / recurring cost / decision criteria / residual value

- 01 **Sam:** A costs ten thousand upfront and B fourteen thousand. The slide calls A the lowest-cost choice. Is that too broad?
- 02 **Priya:** Yes. It compares ¹ _____, not the full cost basis. Both options have recurring maintenance, and their annual amounts differ enough to change the longer comparison.
- 03 **Sam:** A needs two thousand dollars a year in maintenance; B needs one thousand. We are using ten years and constant annual figures, without discounting.
- 04 **Priya:** Keep that ² _____ visible. For A, ten thousand plus ten times two thousand gives thirty thousand dollars. We should not compare ten years of one option with one year of another.
- 05 **Sam:** B totals twenty-four thousand: fourteen thousand plus ten times one thousand. That is six thousand lower on this basis.
- 06 **Priya:** Correct. The ³ _____ reverses the purchase-price ranking. But describe that as a purchase-and-maintenance result, not proof that B is the best asset for every purpose.
- 07 **Sam:** The calculation leaves out installation, energy, downtime, disposal, and residual value. We also have not established that both options satisfy the technical requirements equally.
- 08 **Priya:** State the ⁴ _____ beside the totals. An omitted cost is not automatically zero. The audience should see what this comparison answers and what still requires assessment.
- 09 **Sam:** Then I should remove the phrase complete ownership cost.
- 10 **Priya:** Exactly. ⁵ _____ needs an explicit scope and period. Our figures cover only two categories, so we should not imply that all relevant ownership effects have been evaluated.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Sam:** The maintenance forecast is uncertain. Could we test a different amount for B to show how sensitive the result is to that assumption?
- 12 **Priya:** Use a ⁶ _____. At sixteen hundred dollars a year, B's ten-year maintenance is sixteen thousand, bringing its total with purchase to thirty thousand dollars.
- 13 **Sam:** That would match A on this limited basis. It would not prove the two options have identical performance, risks, or costs outside the comparison.
- 14 **Priya:** Correct. ⁷ _____ remains unassessed. A matching subtotal does not tell us whether either option meets the required duty, reliability, operating conditions, or other technical criteria.
- 15 **Sam:** We also have no residual-value estimate. One asset might retain more value at the end of ten years, but we cannot assume an amount.
- 16 **Priya:** Keep ⁸ _____ among the exclusions. The same applies to disposal costs and downtime. We need their actual basis before including them in a wider analysis.
- 17 **Sam:** Should we label the numbers present values? The slide uses a finance heading, but our arithmetic simply adds the stated amounts over ten years.
- 18 **Priya:** No. This is not ⁹ _____. We have not applied a discount rate. Use undiscounted purchase-and-maintenance comparison so the heading does not promise an analysis we did not perform.
- 19 **Sam:** I will show A at thirty thousand and B at twenty-four thousand, with the alternative B-maintenance case, exclusions, and no purchase approval.
- 20 **Priya:** Good. Put the unresolved ¹⁰ _____ beside those figures. Affordability, technical suitability, risk, and the wider cost basis remain part of the actual decision, not assumptions hidden by a low price.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. purchase price | 2. assessment horizon | 3. recurring cost | 4. cost boundary | 5. Total cost of ownership | 6. sensitivity analysis | 7. Technical equivalence | 8. residual value | 9. discounted cash flow | 10. decision criteria

Compare the same included costs

F Say it

Over five years, C costs \$8,000 plus \$1,000 annual maintenance. D costs \$10,000 plus \$400 annual maintenance. Use undiscounted purchase and maintenance only.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

12,000 / 13,000 / 1,000 / other

Analyst: "C totals \$¹ _____."

Manager: "D totals \$² _____."

Analyst: "D is \$³ _____ lower on this basis."

Manager: "The comparison excludes ⁴ _____ costs."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. 13,000 | 2. 12,000 | 3. 1,000 | 4. other

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Requested resources are not all available

A Read the situation

Hand over storm-response resources with exact counts, distinct statuses, and a clear receiving owner.

06

At the 19:30 local coordination handover, six external crews have been requested. Three are confirmed: one is at the staging location and two are en route. The other three remain unconfirmed. Twenty lodging spaces were requested; twelve are confirmed and eight are pending. Arrival times for the two traveling crews are not verified. Outgoing coordinator Daniel hands over to Sofia, who accepts tracking the open requests and providing the next status update at 20:00. Confirmed, arrived, briefed, and authorized for deployment are separate stages; this record establishes no new operational assignment or restoration promise.

PEOPLE / Daniel: Outgoing logistics coordinator | Sofia: Incoming logistics coordinator

TOTALS CAN HIDE DIFFERENT STAGES

A fast handover often compresses requested, confirmed, and arrived into available. Use the categories explicitly and check whether one count is a subset of another. A concise but structured read-back is more useful than a larger total that double-counts people or resources.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many requested crews are confirmed?

A Six

B Five

C One

D Three

2. How many of the confirmed crews have arrived at staging?

A Two

B Six

C One

D Three

3. How many lodging spaces remain pending?

A Eight

B Twelve

C Twenty

D Three

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

emergency operations center (EOC)

A location or function coordinating information and resources during an emergency.

IN USE support the emergency operations center

incident command

The authority structure directing an incident response under the applicable system.

IN USE coordinate with incident command

mutual assistance

Support provided by other organizations under applicable arrangements.

IN USE request mutual assistance

resource request

A documented request for specified people, equipment, or support.

IN USE track a resource request

resource confirmation

Verification that the requested resource is committed on stated terms.

IN USE obtain resource confirmation

staging location

A designated place where resources assemble before further assignment.

IN USE report arrival at staging

mobilization

Preparing and moving resources for an assigned response.

IN USE track mobilization status

demobilization

Organized release and return of resources when no longer required.

IN USE plan demobilization

en route

Traveling toward the relevant destination, not yet arrived.

IN USE report crews en route

estimated time of arrival (ETA)

An estimate of when a person or resource will reach a destination.

IN USE verify the estimated time of arrival

deployment authorization

Permission to assign or send resources to specified work under the applicable process.

IN USE verify deployment authorization

crew roster

A list of personnel assigned to a crew or response.

IN USE reconcile the crew roster

Precision check

The one arrived crew and two en-route crews are subsets of the three confirmed crews. They are not three additional crews. Six requested minus three confirmed leaves three requests unconfirmed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

credential verification

Checking the relevant qualifications or authorizations of personnel.

IN USE complete credential verification

shift handover

Transfer of current information and responsibilities between shifts.

IN USE conduct a shift handover

operational period

A defined interval used for response planning and coordination.

IN USE identify the operational period

situation report

A structured update of current conditions, actions, and resource status.

IN USE issue a situation report

logistics

Coordination of resources, movement, accommodation, and other support.

IN USE coordinate response logistics

lodging allocation

Assignment of accommodation capacity to the relevant personnel.

IN USE confirm lodging allocation

resource shortfall

The gap between required or requested resources and those available or confirmed.

IN USE identify a resource shortfall

fatigue management

Arrangements to address risks arising from tiredness and work-rest demands.

IN USE follow fatigue-management requirements

communications plan

The defined channels, contacts, and arrangements for response communication.

IN USE follow the communications plan

access restriction

A limitation on entry or movement in an affected area.

IN USE verify access restrictions

request owner

The named person responsible for following up a request.

IN USE identify the request owner

status reconciliation

Checking that different reports describe the same resources without conflict or duplication.

IN USE complete status reconciliation

Precision check

Twelve confirmed lodging spaces are not twenty available spaces. Likewise, crew arrival does not automatically establish briefing, qualification checks, or deployment authorization. The next update time does not promise that the remaining resources will be confirmed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

TIMESTAMP THE HANDOVER

"This is the resource position at 19:30 local time."

SEPARATE CONFIRMATIONS

"Three crews are confirmed and three remain unconfirmed."

AVOID DOUBLE COUNTING

"Those three statuses describe the same confirmed group."

STATE LODGING DEMAND

"Twenty lodging spaces were requested."

STATE THE REQUEST TOTAL

"Six external crews were requested."

BREAK DOWN THE CONFIRMED GROUP

"One confirmed crew is at staging and two are en route."

QUALIFY ARRIVAL TIMING

"Arrival times for the traveling crews are not verified."

STATE LODGING CONFIRMATION

"Twelve spaces are confirmed and eight remain pending."

Of the three

Signals a subset rather than an additional count.

En route

Indicates travel, not confirmed arrival.

Pending

Keeps a request open rather than silently treating it as supplied.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE RECEIVING OWNER

"Sofia has accepted tracking the open requests."

SET THE COMMUNICATION TIME

"The next status update is at 20:00 local time."

PRESERVE OPERATIONAL BOUNDARIES

"Arrival at staging does not itself authorize a work assignment."

REPORT UNCHANGED CONDITIONS

"The next update will include unresolved requests even if their status is unchanged."

SEPARATE ACCEPTANCE FROM SUPPLY

"Accepting the handover does not confirm the missing resources."

AVOID AN AVAILABILITY CLAIM

"Requested does not mean available for deployment."

KEEP CATEGORIES CONSISTENT

"Use requested, confirmed, en route, and arrived as separate status fields."

CLOSE WITH READ-BACK

"Please repeat the crew counts, lodging counts, owner, and next update time."

06

Accepted tracking

Transfers follow-up responsibility without creating a supplier commitment.

As of 19:30

Prevents the handover snapshot from appearing timeless.

At 20:00

Commits to an update, not to resolving every resource shortfall.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which crew summary avoids double counting?

- A** Six requested; six confirmed because three plus one plus two equals six
- B** One confirmed because only one has arrived
- C** Nine requested because three are confirmed
- D** Six requested; three confirmed, comprising one arrived and two en route

2. Which lodging statement is supported?

- A** Twenty available because twenty were requested
- B** Eight confirmed and twelve canceled
- C** Twelve confirmed plus twenty more confirmed
- D** Twelve confirmed; eight pending from a request for twenty

3. What does the 20:00 commitment promise?

- A** All lodging confirmed
- B** Restoration of every affected service point
- C** A new status update
- D** All crews arriving

4. What follows from a crew arriving at staging?

- A** The crew counts twice in the confirmed total.
- B** Arrival is established, while other required deployment stages remain separate.
- C** Every operational assignment is automatically authorized.
- D** All credentials are verified without review.

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Requested resources are not all available

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

situation report / Lodging allocation / Deployment authorization / staging location / estimated time of arrival / resource shortfall / shift handover / en route / status reconciliation / request owner

- 01 **Daniel:** This is the resource position at nineteen thirty local time. Six external crews were requested, and three are confirmed. I need to hand over the remaining requests.
- 02 **Sofia:** I will accept the ¹ _____. First, break down those three confirmed crews. I want to distinguish who has arrived from who is still traveling before I update the situation report.
- 03 **Daniel:** One is at staging and two are en route. Three requested crews remain unconfirmed. Arrival times for the traveling crews are unverified.
- 04 **Sofia:** So the ² _____ group is part of the three confirmed, not an additional two. I will not add one arrived and two traveling to the confirmed total again.
- 05 **Daniel:** Correct. The earlier summary said six available, apparently by adding those categories. That would overstate resources and could mislead the next coordination meeting.
- 06 **Sofia:** I will correct the ³ _____. It should show six requested, three confirmed, and three unconfirmed, with the arrival breakdown nested within the confirmed group.
- 07 **Daniel:** Lodging also needs a qualification: twenty spaces requested, twelve confirmed, eight pending. The request remains open.
- 08 **Sofia:** I will record that ⁴ _____ explicitly. A request for twenty does not mean twenty spaces are available, and we should not assign accommodation on the basis of the request alone.
- 09 **Daniel:** Please take ownership of both the unconfirmed crews and the pending lodging spaces. I want the outgoing record to identify who is following them up.
- 10 **Sofia:** I accept that as the ⁵ _____. My acceptance transfers coordination responsibility, not supplier confirmation. The open requests remain open until their status is verified and recorded.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Daniel:** When is your next update? The coordination lead needs a consistent time to refresh the resource summary across the response team.
- 12 **Sofia:** Twenty hundred local time. I will provide a ⁶ _____ then, including any requests still unresolved. That is an information commitment, not a promise that every crew or lodging space will be confirmed.
- 13 **Daniel:** The crew at staging has arrived, but this snapshot says nothing about its briefing, qualification checks, or an authorized work assignment. Please keep those stages separate.
- 14 **Sofia:** Agreed. Arrival at the ⁷ _____ is not permission to deploy. I will leave the applicable operational checks and assignments with the authorized response process rather than infer them from presence.
- 15 **Daniel:** Someone may ask whether these crews will restore a neighborhood tonight. Our logistics counts cannot support that promise, and no such assignment is established.
- 16 **Sofia:** Correct. ⁸ _____ and restoration planning are separate operational matters. I can report the resource status without claiming when any particular service point will be restored.
- 17 **Daniel:** We also need to avoid inventing an arrival estimate for the two traveling crews. Their confirmed participation does not tell us their current location or travel conditions.
- 18 **Sofia:** I will mark the ⁹ _____ as unverified. Any update needs its source and time basis, particularly if access restrictions or other conditions change during the response.
- 19 **Daniel:** Please read the final numbers back so I can close the administrative handover without leaving a different version in my outgoing report.
- 20 **Sofia:** Six crews requested, three confirmed: one at staging, two en route. Three unconfirmed. ¹⁰ _____ is twelve confirmed, eight pending. I own follow-up and will update at twenty hundred local time.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. shift handover | 2. en route | 3. situation report | 4. resource shortfall | 5. request owner | 6. status reconciliation | 7. staging location | 8. Deployment authorization | 9. estimated time of arrival | 10. Lodging allocation

Count subsets only once

F Say it

Eight crews are requested; five confirmed crews comprise two at staging and three en route. Three remain unconfirmed. Eighteen lodging spaces are requested and fourteen confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

three / four / fourteen / five

Coordinator: "The confirmed crew total is ¹ _____."

Receiver: "The unconfirmed crew count is ² _____."

Coordinator: "Confirmed lodging spaces total ³ _____."

Receiver: "The lodging shortfall is ⁴ _____ spaces."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. five | 2. three | 3. fourteen | 4. four

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Lower consumption does not isolate the program effect

A Read the situation

Report an observed energy reduction while separating measurement, explanation, and verified savings.

A fictional office used 10,000 kWh in a baseline month and 8,500 kWh in a post-installation month after an efficiency retrofit. Both readings cover 30 days. The second month had milder weather and average daily occupancy fell from 40 to 30 people. No adjusted baseline or agreed savings-verification analysis has been completed. Program specialist Leila finds a draft claiming the retrofit proved 15% savings and a 15% bill reduction. Analyst Victor must help report the observed 1,500 kWh, or 15%, consumption decline without assigning the entire change to the retrofit. Rates and bill components are not supplied.

PEOPLE / Leila: Efficiency program specialist | Victor: Energy analyst

07

A QUALIFIED RESULT CAN STILL BE USEFUL

Teams may feel pressure to turn a promising result into a simple success claim. State the observed change clearly, then name the factors that prevent stronger attribution. This preserves useful evidence without treating either enthusiasm or skepticism as a substitute for analysis.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What measured energy change is supplied?

- A A guaranteed 15% bill reduction
- C A 1,500 kWh reduction, equal to 15% of baseline use

- B A 1,500 kW fall in peak demand
- D A proved 15% retrofit effect

2. Which other conditions changed?

- A The currency used on the bill
- C Only the equipment, with all conditions fixed

- B Weather and occupancy
- D The reading period from 30 to 60 days

3. What has not been completed?

- A The two monthly readings
- C The arithmetic difference between the readings

- B Identification of the reading periods
- D An adjusted baseline and savings-verification analysis

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

energy efficiency

Providing the relevant service with less energy under a defined comparison.

IN USE improve energy efficiency

energy conservation

Reducing energy use through changes in behavior, service, or activity.

IN USE encourage energy conservation

retrofit

A modification or addition to improve an existing system or building.

IN USE assess an efficiency retrofit

energy conservation measure (ECM)

A defined intervention intended to reduce energy or related resource use.

IN USE evaluate an energy conservation measure

baseline period

The reference period used to establish pre-intervention conditions or use.

IN USE define the baseline period

reporting period

The period for which performance or results are being assessed.

IN USE identify the reporting period

metered consumption

Energy use measured by the relevant meter over a stated interval.

IN USE compare metered consumption

measurement and verification (M&V)

A defined process for assessing and verifying savings against an appropriate basis.

IN USE develop a measurement and verification plan

adjusted baseline

Reference use adjusted to relevant comparison conditions under an explicit method.

IN USE calculate an adjusted baseline

weather normalization

Adjusting energy analysis to a defined weather basis.

IN USE apply weather normalization

heating degree days

A weather indicator based on temperature relative to a specified heating reference.

IN USE use heating degree days

cooling degree days

A weather indicator based on temperature relative to a specified cooling reference.

IN USE use cooling degree days

Precision check

The observed reduction is 1,500 kWh divided by the baseline 10,000 kWh, or 15%. It is measured consumption change, not yet a verified retrofit effect. Milder weather and lower occupancy also changed the comparison.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

occupancy

The presence or number of people using a space over a defined basis.

IN USE track occupancy changes

operating hours

The time during which a facility or system is operated.

IN USE document operating hours

independent variable

An input used to explain variation in another measured quantity.

IN USE identify relevant independent variables

confounding factor

A factor that complicates attribution of an observed change to one cause.

IN USE account for confounding factors

attribution

Assigning an observed effect to a particular cause or intervention.

IN USE qualify savings attribution

avoided energy use

Energy estimated not to have been used compared with an appropriate counterfactual basis.

IN USE estimate avoided energy use

gross savings

Savings associated with an intervention before specified program-attribution adjustments.

IN USE distinguish gross savings

net savings

Program savings after the relevant adjustments for attribution and other specified effects.

IN USE assess net savings

rebound effect

Increased use of a service that may offset some expected efficiency savings.

IN USE assess the rebound effect

persistence

The extent to which an effect continues over time.

IN USE evaluate savings persistence

uncertainty

The limits on confidence or precision in an estimate or conclusion.

IN USE report savings uncertainty

bill savings

A reduction in monetary charges under the relevant rates and billing conditions.

IN USE distinguish bill savings

Precision check

Energy savings and bill savings are not interchangeable. Prices, fixed charges, demand charges, and other billing components can affect the money paid. This case supplies no rate information, so it supports no bill-savings percentage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE READINGS

"Consumption fell from ten thousand to eight thousand five hundred kilowatt-hours."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"The observed reduction is fifteen hundred kilowatt-hours."

QUALIFY ATTRIBUTION

"We cannot assign the whole decline to the retrofit from these readings alone."

NAME THE OCCUPANCY CHANGE

"Average daily occupancy fell from forty to thirty people."

NAME THE PERIOD

"Both readings cover thirty days."

STATE THE DENOMINATOR

"That is fifteen percent of baseline consumption."

NAME THE WEATHER CHANGE

"The reporting month had milder weather."

AVOID A FALSE CONSTANT

"The comparison conditions were not unchanged."

07

Fell from

Describes an observed change without assigning its cause.

Because of

Adds a causal claim that these readings alone do not establish.

Of baseline

Identifies the denominator for the 15% calculation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

IDENTIFY THE MISSING ANALYSIS

"An adjusted baseline and verification analysis have not been completed."

PRESERVE THE UNIT

"These figures are energy in kilowatt-hours, not peak power in kilowatts."

KEEP THE RESULT USEFUL

"The decline is real in the supplied readings, while its causes remain to be assessed."

AVOID INVENTED ADJUSTMENTS

"Do not subtract an assumed weather effect without a supported method."

DISTINGUISH THE MEASURES

"Lower energy use does not automatically mean the same percentage reduction in the bill."

CORRECT THE CLAIM

"Replace proved savings with observed consumption reduction."

STATE THE METHOD BOUNDARY

"Use the applicable measurement and verification plan for a verified savings claim."

CLOSE WITH THE EVIDENCE

"Report the readings, changed conditions, and unresolved attribution together."

Same period length

Removes one difference but does not make all conditions comparable.

Not yet verified

Does not mean that the intervention had no effect.

Energy versus money

Distinguishes consumption units from the monetary bill.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which headline is supported?

- A** Peak demand fell 1,500 kW.
- B** Metered use fell 15%; retrofit attribution remains unverified.
- C** Retrofit proved exactly 15% savings.
- D** Every customer bill will fall 15%.

2. Why do equal 30-day periods not settle attribution?

- A** Equal periods make all other factors identical.
- B** Thirty days always proves program savings.
- C** The meter must be wrong if conditions changed.
- D** Weather and occupancy still differed.

3. What is the occupancy decline?

- A** 33.3% of the original forty
- B** 25%, from 40 to 30 people
- C** 10%, because ten people fewer means ten percent
- D** 15%, matching the energy decline

4. Which bill statement is justified?

- A** The fixed charge necessarily disappeared.
- B** A kilowatt-hour equals a dollar.
- C** Bill savings cannot be calculated from the supplied information.
- D** The bill necessarily fell by 15%.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Lower consumption does not isolate the program effect

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

attribution / Occupancy / confounding factors / reporting period / metered consumption / bill savings / measurement and verification / Uncertainty / Weather normalization / adjusted baseline

07

- 01 **Leila:** The draft says our retrofit proved fifteen percent energy savings and the same reduction in bills. The meter readings fell, but can we support both claims?
- 02 **Victor:** We can support the ¹ _____ change: ten thousand to eight thousand five hundred kilowatt-hours. That is fifteen hundred less, or fifteen percent of the original reading.
- 03 **Leila:** Both readings cover thirty days. I initially thought matching the period length meant we could attribute the whole difference to the equipment installed between them.
- 04 **Victor:** It removes one difference, but the ² _____ had milder weather and fewer occupants. Those changes can affect energy use, so the conditions were not otherwise held constant.
- 05 **Leila:** Average daily occupancy fell from forty to thirty people. That is ten fewer, or twenty-five percent of the original forty, not a ten percent change.
- 06 **Victor:** Correct. ³ _____ is a separate measured condition. We cannot assume its effect on energy is proportional to the headcount change or simply subtract twenty-five percent.
- 07 **Leila:** So we should not try to correct the energy result with a guessed number for people, then assign whatever remains to the retrofit.
- 08 **Victor:** Exactly. An ⁴ _____ needs an explicit, supported method. It is not an informal subtraction that makes the result fit the program story.
- 09 **Leila:** The weather changed too. The second month was milder, but we have not quantified the resulting heating or cooling effect in this analysis.
- 10 **Victor:** ⁵ _____ may form part of the applicable method. The appropriate approach must be established from the project and data, not improvised from the word milder.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Leila:** I want the corrected headline to remain useful. Saying we know nothing would also be inaccurate, because the supplied readings clearly show lower energy use.
- 12 **Victor:** Say observed consumption fell fifteen percent, with ⁶ _____ to the retrofit unverified. That preserves both the measured result and the limit on what it demonstrates about the intervention.
- 13 **Leila:** Would it be fair to say the retrofit had no effect until verification is complete? Some colleagues hear an unverified claim as a disproved claim.
- 14 **Victor:** No. ⁷ _____ is not a finding of zero benefit. We have not isolated the effect, and that means we should avoid both an exact success claim and an unsupported dismissal.
- 15 **Leila:** The monetary claim needs correcting as well. We have no rates, fixed charges, credits, demand charges, or other billing information in the supplied case.
- 16 **Victor:** Then we cannot calculate ⁸ _____. A fifteen percent energy decline does not automatically produce a fifteen percent bill decline, even when the energy readings themselves are accurate.
- 17 **Leila:** I will keep the units visible. Kilowatt-hours measure the energy used over the period; these monthly readings do not establish what happened to peak demand.
- 18 **Victor:** Good. The ⁹ _____ process needs the relevant comparison conditions and method. Our immediate communication should identify the missing analysis rather than invent its outcome.
- 19 **Leila:** The revised summary will give both readings, the equal thirty-day periods, the weather and occupancy changes, and the fact that no adjusted analysis is complete.
- 20 **Victor:** That makes the ¹⁰ _____ visible. Keep the fifteen percent as an observed consumption reduction, not a certified savings result or a promise about future bills.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. metered consumption | 2. reporting period | 3. Occupancy | 4. adjusted baseline | 5. Weather normalization | 6. attribution | 7. Uncertainty | 8. bill savings | 9. measurement and verification | 10. confounding factors

Report a decline without inventing its cause

F Say it

Two equal-length periods show 12,000 and 10,800 kWh. Weather and operating hours changed. No adjusted analysis or billing rates are supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

10 / 1,200 / calculable / unverified

Analyst: "The observed reduction is ¹ _____ kWh."

Manager: "That equals ² _____ percent of baseline use."

Analyst: "Attribution to the intervention remains ³ _____."

Manager: "Monetary bill savings are not ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. 1,200 | 2. 10 | 3. unverified | 4. calculable

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Fewer interruptions, more total outage minutes

A Read the situation

Translate reliability indices, check a comparison, and distinguish a metric trend from an investment promise.

A fictional utility serves 1,000 customers in each of two years. Using the same sustained-interruption definitions and event coverage, Year 1 records 1,200 customer interruptions and 90,000 customer-minutes interrupted. Year 2 records 1,000 customer interruptions and 120,000 customer-minutes interrupted. The same major-event treatment applies in both years. Analyst Ravi presents the results to community liaison Celia. A draft headline says reliability improved on every measure. A proposed investment is also described as guaranteed to reduce next-year interruptions, although no validated impact estimate is supplied. Both claims need qualification.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Reliability analyst | Celia: Community liaison

08

TRANSLATE AN AVERAGE WITHOUT TURNING IT INTO EVERYBODY

Community members may compare an average with their own outage experience and conclude that one must be wrong. Explain the population and units. An average can describe the system accurately while concealing substantial differences between individual customers or neighborhoods.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Year 1 SAIFI?

- A 1,200 interruptions for every customer
- B 0.9 interruptions per customer
- C 1.2 interruptions per customer
- D 90 minutes per customer

2. What is Year 2 SAIDI?

- A 1 interruption per customer
- B 120,000 minutes for every customer
- C 12 minutes per customer
- D 120 minutes per customer

3. Which overall description matches the two indices?

- A Both frequency and duration improved.
- B Every customer had exactly one interruption.
- C The proposed investment already reduced the results.
- D Average frequency fell while average total interruption duration rose.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

System Average Interruption Duration Index (SAIDI)

Average total sustained-interruption time per customer over a stated period.

IN USE explain SAIDI in minutes

System Average Interruption Frequency Index (SAIFI)

Average sustained-interruption count per customer over a stated period.

IN USE explain SAIFI as frequency

sustained interruption

An interruption meeting the duration threshold in the applicable reporting definition.

IN USE define sustained interruptions

customer interruption

One counted interruption affecting one customer.

IN USE count customer interruptions

customer-minute interrupted

One interruption minute for one customer.

IN USE sum customer-minutes interrupted

customers served

The customer population used as the denominator.

IN USE state customers served

Customer Average Interruption Duration Index (CAIDI)

Average duration per sustained customer interruption on a stated basis.

IN USE distinguish CAIDI from SAIDI

momentary interruption

A short interruption classified under the applicable reporting definition.

IN USE distinguish momentary interruptions

major event day

A day classified as a major event under the stated reliability methodology.

IN USE state major-event-day treatment

event coverage

The set of events included in a reported measure.

IN USE align event coverage

reporting methodology

The definitions and procedures used to calculate the measures.

IN USE document the reporting methodology

denominator

The quantity by which another is divided to calculate a ratio or average.

IN USE check the denominator

Precision check

SAIFI is 1.2 in Year 1 and 1.0 in Year 2. SAIDI is 90 and 120 minutes respectively. Frequency fell, but total interruption duration per customer rose. The headline improved on every measure is therefore false.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

frequency

How often counted events occur over the stated period or basis.

IN USE explain interruption frequency

duration

How long an interruption or accumulated interruption time lasts.

IN USE explain interruption duration

system average

A measure averaged over the defined system population.

IN USE qualify the system average

distribution of outcomes

How results vary across customers, locations, or events.

IN USE examine the distribution of outcomes

reliability trend

The direction of change in defined service-reliability measures over time.

IN USE interpret the reliability trend

resilience

The ability to withstand, adapt to, and recover from disruptive events.

IN USE distinguish resilience from a single reliability index

investment proposal

A plan requesting resources for a specified project or improvement.

IN USE assess an investment proposal

benefit estimate

An estimate of the favorable effects expected from an action.

IN USE validate the benefit estimate

business case

The stated rationale, costs, benefits, risks, and assumptions supporting a decision.

IN USE review the business case

counterfactual

An estimate or model of what would occur without the intervention.

IN USE establish the counterfactual basis

target outcome

The result an initiative aims to achieve, not a guaranteed result.

IN USE distinguish the target outcome

performance commitment

A defined undertaking about performance on a specified basis.

IN USE qualify the performance commitment

08

Precision check

On this same basis, CAIDI is $90/1.2 = 75$ minutes in Year 1 and $120/1.0 = 120$ minutes in Year 2. These averages do not mean every customer had identical experiences, and historical trends do not guarantee an investment effect.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

DEFINE FREQUENCY

"SAIFI describes average sustained interruptions per customer."

STATE THE PERIOD

"These figures cover each full reporting year."

CALCULATE YEAR 1 FREQUENCY

"Twelve hundred divided by one thousand gives 1.2."

CALCULATE YEAR 1 DURATION

"Ninety thousand customer-minutes divided by one thousand gives ninety minutes."

DEFINE TOTAL DURATION

"SAIDI describes average total sustained-interruption minutes per customer."

SHOW THE DENOMINATOR

"Both years use one thousand customers."

CALCULATE YEAR 2 FREQUENCY

"One thousand divided by one thousand gives 1.0."

CALCULATE YEAR 2 DURATION

"One hundred twenty thousand divided by one thousand gives one hundred twenty minutes."

08

Per customer

Uses the served population, including those with no counted interruption.

Per interruption

Uses interruption counts rather than all customers served.

Total duration

Accumulates time across relevant interruptions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SUMMARIZE THE MIXED TREND

"Interruptions were less frequent on average, but total interruption time increased."

QUALIFY THE AVERAGE

"Individual customers may have experienced different outcomes."

DISTINGUISH CAIDI

"CAIDI describes average duration per customer interruption, not per customer served."

QUALIFY THE INVESTMENT

"The proposed benefit needs a supported estimate and assumptions."

CORRECT THE HEADLINE

"The data do not show improvement on every measure."

CHECK THE COMPARISON

"Use the same definitions, event coverage, and major-event treatment."

SEPARATE RESILIENCE

"A single annual index does not describe every aspect of resilience."

CLOSE WITH THE DECISION

"Present the measured trend separately from the investment proposal and its uncertainty."

08

On average

Does not claim that every customer experienced the same result.

Same coverage

Makes the comparison meaningful across reporting periods.

Guaranteed

Is unsupported by the unvalidated investment estimate in this case.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which Year 1 calculation gives CAIDI?

- A** 1,200 divided by 1,000 = 1.2 minutes
- B** 1,000 divided by 90,000 = 90 minutes
- C** 90,000 customer-minutes divided by 1,200 customer interruptions = 75 minutes
- D** 90,000 divided by 1,000 = 90 minutes

08

2. Which interpretation of Year 2 SAIFI is accurate?

- A** All customers were interrupted at the same time.
- B** The system average is one counted interruption per customer.
- C** Every customer had exactly one interruption.
- D** Every interruption lasted one minute.

3. What must be aligned for the comparison?

- A** Only the larger number
- B** Only the proposed investment title
- C** Definitions, reporting periods, population basis, and event coverage
- D** Only the chart colors

4. Which investment statement is supported?

- A** The proposal automatically removes every outage.
- B** The benefit remains a proposal requiring a validated basis.
- C** Historical averages guarantee next year's result.
- D** The draft heading proves the investment caused improvement.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Fewer interruptions, more total outage minutes

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

denominator / frequency / target outcome / SAIDI / reporting methodology / system average / resilience / event coverage / CAIDI / duration

08

- 01 **Celia:** The headline says reliability improved on every measure, but the chart shows SAIDI increasing. I need a clear explanation before presenting this to community representatives.
- 02 **Ravi:** Start with ¹ _____. SAIFI is the average count of sustained interruptions per customer. It falls from one point two in Year 1 to one in Year 2.
- 03 **Celia:** We get those figures by dividing twelve hundred customer interruptions and then one thousand by the same thousand customers served in each year.
- 04 **Ravi:** Correct. Keep the ² _____ visible. It is the defined customer population, not only the customers who experienced interruptions, and it does not count network equipment failures.
- 05 **Celia:** A resident could have had three interruptions even when the average is one. We should not make the system figure sound like everybody had the same experience.
- 06 **Ravi:** Exactly. A ³ _____ can coexist with uneven outcomes. Some customers may have none and others several; the average alone does not describe that distribution.
- 07 **Celia:** Now the duration measure. We have ninety thousand customer-minutes in Year 1 and a hundred twenty thousand in Year 2, again across a thousand customers.
- 08 **Ravi:** That gives ⁴ _____ of ninety and one hundred twenty minutes. It measures total interruption time per customer over the year, not the length of one typical incident.
- 09 **Celia:** Then interruptions became less frequent on average, but customers experienced more total interruption time on the system-average basis. That is a mixed trend, not universal improvement.
- 10 **Ravi:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ measure worsened while frequency improved. We must say both, rather than choose whichever number supports the preferred headline about overall progress.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Celia:** Someone may ask how long an interruption lasted on average. That requires a different denominator from the number of customers served, does it not?
- 12 **Ravi:** Use ⁶ _____ on this same measurement basis: ninety thousand divided by twelve hundred is seventy-five minutes; one hundred twenty thousand divided by one thousand is one hundred twenty minutes.
- 13 **Celia:** So CAIDI is duration per customer interruption, while SAIDI is accumulated duration per customer served. Similar acronyms conceal an important distinction.
- 14 **Ravi:** Correct. Also preserve the ⁷ _____. The supplied years use the same sustained-interruption definitions and major-event treatment, which is necessary for interpreting the comparison we just made.
- 15 **Celia:** If a later chart excluded major events in one year but included them in the other, the apparent trend could reflect that change rather than comparable performance.
- 16 **Ravi:** Exactly. State the ⁸ _____, period, and scope. Readers should not have to discover a changed definition after reacting to a large improvement or deterioration in the headline.
- 17 **Celia:** The investment slide promises fewer interruptions next year, but we have no validated estimate explaining the size or certainty of that effect.
- 18 **Ravi:** Then label it a ⁹ _____, not a guarantee. The business case needs a supported benefit estimate, assumptions, costs, and risks; these historical indices cannot supply that causal forecast by themselves.
- 19 **Celia:** I will present the two measured trends, explain the averages, and place the investment proposal in a separate section with its remaining evidence needs.
- 20 **Ravi:** Good. Community questions about ¹⁰ _____ may reach beyond these annual averages. Explain what the indices measure accurately, then identify the additional evidence needed rather than stretching one number to answer everything.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. frequency | 2. denominator | 3. system average | 4. SAIDI | 5. duration | 6. CAIDI | 7. event coverage | 8. reporting methodology | 9. target outcome | 10. resilience

Compute two distinct indices

F Say it

A fictional year has 500 customers served, 750 sustained customer interruptions, and 60,000 customer-minutes interrupted on one consistent reporting basis.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

1.5 / 80 / 120 / averages

08

Analyst: "SAIFI is ¹ _____ interruptions per customer."

Liaison: "SAIDI is ² _____ minutes per customer."

Analyst: "CAIDI is ³ _____ minutes per interruption."

Liaison: "These are ⁴ _____, not identical individual experiences."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. 1.5 | 2. 120 | 3. 80 | 4. averages

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Grid Reliability and Outage Response

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is verified at 16:10?

C. 420 affected service points in the Oak district

The supplied operations update verifies the affected count and area, not cause or restoration time.

2. What does 16:40 represent?

A. The next status update

Paul commits to another verified status update, even if restoration timing remains unavailable.

3. Which crew statement is accurate?

D. A crew is assigned; arrival is unconfirmed.

Assignment is confirmed, but the brief explicitly leaves crew arrival unconfirmed.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which public update matches the record?

C. At 16:10, 420 service points are affected; restoration timing is under assessment; next update 16:40.

The accurate update preserves the count, timestamp, unresolved estimate, and communication commitment.

2. Which phrase wrongly strengthens the crew status?

A. Crews are on site.

On site claims arrival, which the supplied facts do not confirm.

3. What should happen if no estimate exists at 16:40?

D. Provide the promised update and state that timing remains under assessment.

The commitment is to provide status information, not to produce a certainty that does not exist.

4. What does the 420 figure count?

A. Service points in the verified snapshot

The supplied unit is affected service points, and the figure is limited to a timestamped snapshot.

01 Conversation answers

Grid Reliability and Outage Response

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. planning assumption.** Turn 2. A planning assumption is an unverified basis for a plan, not a confirmed restoration estimate suitable for a promise.
- 2. status snapshot.** Turn 4. The status snapshot describes known conditions at a stated time, not a final total or prediction of the outage's full scope.
- 3. crew assignment.** Turn 6. Crew assignment means a crew has been allocated; it does not establish arrival, repair progress, or restoration.
- 4. outage management system.** Turn 8. The outage management system supports tracking the incident, but communications must preserve the actual verified status recorded through operations.
- 5. update commitment.** Turn 10. An update commitment promises further information at a specified time, not restoration or a completed assessment by that time.
- 6. estimated restoration time.** Turn 12. Estimated restoration time concerns when service may return; the next communication time is not a substitute for that operational estimate.
- 7. Damage assessment.** Turn 14. Damage assessment evaluates actual damage and conditions; an unverified guess about equipment failure must not replace its findings.
- 8. outage footprint.** Turn 16. The outage footprint is the verified affected area or service-point set; here it is the Oak district snapshot, not an invented wider impact.
- 9. restoration sequence.** Turn 18. The restoration sequence is an authorized operational matter; a public communications update does not direct switching or establish electrical safety.
- 10. crew arrival.** Turn 20. Crew arrival is a distinct verified event that can be reported when confirmed, without automatically implying repair completion or restoration.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. 180

Officer: "The verified affected count is 180 service points."

One hundred eighty is the supplied service-point count for this snapshot.

2. Pine

Liaison: "The affected district is Pine."

Pine is the named district in the separate outage case.

3. 09:50

Officer: "The next information update is at 09:50."

Nine fifty is the stated communication time, not a restoration estimate.

4. assessment

Liaison: "Restoration timing remains under assessment."

The brief explicitly leaves restoration timing under assessment rather than confirmed.

02 Briefing and language checks

Safety, Field Work, and Switching

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which identifiers conflict?

B. Q27 and Q72

The work package identifies Q27 while the switching request identifies Q72.

2. Which identifier is correct from the supplied facts?

C. It has not been established.

The case provides no verified basis for selecting either conflicting identifier.

3. What does a repeat-back establish?

D. That the discrepancy and current hold were understood

Repeating the message confirms communication, not the equipment condition or operating authority.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which message preserves the discrepancy?

D. Work package Q27; switching request Q72; correct reference unresolved; task on hold.

The accurate message gives both exact identifiers and preserves the unresolved status and hold.

2. What should happen to the conflicting records?

D. Preserve them and use the authorized reconciliation process.

Traceable reconciliation preserves the evidence and avoids inventing a correct identifier.

3. Which conclusion is not supported by a read-back?

B. The equipment is safe to work on.

Communication accuracy does not establish electrical state, work safety, or operating authorization.

4. Which response to schedule pressure is appropriate?

D. The identifier conflict remains unresolved; the task stays on hold under the local process.

The local hold cannot be replaced by an unverified choice or a language-practice script.

02 Conversation answers

Safety, Field Work, and Switching

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. equipment identifier.** Turn 2. The equipment identifier distinguishes the actual asset; Q27 and Q72 cannot be treated as equivalent.
- 2. document reconciliation.** Turn 4. Document reconciliation resolves conflicting references through authorized review, not silent editing to match an assumption.
- 3. work package.** Turn 6. The work package contains task information, but its identifier is not automatically correct merely because it appears first.
- 4. read-back.** Turn 8. Read-back confirms the received identifiers and task status; it does not verify the asset or provide operating permission.
- 5. hold point.** Turn 10. The hold point prevents the affected activity from proceeding until the specified review and authorization requirements have been satisfied.
- 6. deenergized.** Turn 12. Deenergized status requires the applicable hazardous-energy process; an outage map or uncertain label does not establish it.
- 7. Operating authority.** Turn 14. Operating authority belongs to the people assigned the relevant decisions under the actual procedure; this dialogue does not confer it.
- 8. system operator.** Turn 16. The system operator is the named coordinator here; accepting that role does not itself resolve the discrepancy or release the task.
- 9. revision control.** Turn 18. Revision control establishes the applicable document issue and status; a newer-looking file name alone is not sufficient evidence.
- 10. switching request.** Turn 20. A switching request asks for activity; it is not itself a verified authorized instruction to perform that activity.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. R18

Lead: "The work package identifies R18."

R18 is the identifier printed in the supplied work package.

2. R81

Operator: "The associated request identifies R81."

R81 is the conflicting identifier in the supplied request.

3. Ema

Lead: "The review coordinator is Ema."

Ema is the named person coordinating this separate review.

4. hold

Operator: "The affected task remains on hold."

The brief preserves the task hold while the correct reference remains unresolved.

03 Briefing and language checks

Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is the proposal's current status?

D. Under review, with no approval or effective date established

The supplied notice describes an unapproved proposal with no established effective date.

2. What does the 5% figure describe?

D. The energy-charge rate increase from \$0.10 to \$0.105 per kWh

The percentage applies to the energy rate component, while the fixed charge remains unchanged.

3. What is the current simplified bill at 500 kWh?

C. \$70

Five hundred times \$0.10 is \$50, plus the \$20 fixed charge gives \$70.

D Language checks / page 27

1. What would the proposed energy charge be at 500 kWh?

C. \$52.50

Five hundred multiplied by \$0.105 per kWh gives \$52.50 before the fixed charge.

2. What would the simplified total be?

D. \$72.50

The proposed \$52.50 energy charge plus the unchanged \$20 fixed charge totals \$72.50.

3. Which percentage statement is accurate?

C. The energy rate rises 5%; this example total rises about 3.57%.

The unchanged fixed charge means the total's percentage increase differs from the energy-rate increase.

4. Which customer statement preserves the status?

B. This is a conditional illustration, not an approved change to your account.

The proposal remains unapproved and the actual account has not been reviewed.

03 Conversation answers

Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. proposed rate.** Turn 2. The proposed rate is under consideration; the notice does not establish approval or a current change to the customer's account.
- 2. volumetric charge.** Turn 4. The volumetric charge depends on consumption; the proposed percentage increase concerns its per-kWh rate, not every component of the total bill.
- 3. usage assumption.** Turn 6. The usage assumption fixes consumption at 500 kWh so the example isolates the proposed rate change rather than changing both rate and usage.
- 4. fixed charge.** Turn 8. The fixed charge is the unchanged \$20 component in this example; it must be added to the energy charge to obtain the total.
- 5. bill impact.** Turn 10. Bill impact concerns the total charge; the example's \$2.50 increase on \$70 is about 3.57%, not the component rate's 5%.
- 6. customer class.** Turn 12. Customer class can determine applicable rate treatment; the simplified example does not establish the terms governing Mr Diaz's actual account.
- 7. docket.** Turn 14. The docket is the proceeding's official record or identifier, allowing the customer to locate the proposal and relevant decisions.
- 8. approved rate.** Turn 16. An approved rate is the outcome accepted through the relevant process; it need not be identical to the original proposal.
- 9. effective date.** Turn 18. The effective date identifies when a provision begins to operate; the supplied case establishes neither that date nor an approval.
- 10. rate design.** Turn 20. Rate design is the structure of charges; separating its components explains why a component-rate percentage differs from the total-bill effect.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 60

Adviser: "The current total is \$60."

Four hundred times ten cents is forty dollars, plus twenty gives sixty.

2. 42

Customer: "The proposed energy component would be \$42."

Four hundred multiplied by \$0.105 gives a forty-two-dollar energy charge.

3. 62

Adviser: "The proposed total would be \$62."

Forty-two dollars plus the unchanged twenty-dollar charge gives sixty-two.

4. unapproved

Customer: "The proposal remains unapproved."

The supplied case explicitly labels the proposed rate as unapproved.

04 Briefing and language checks

Renewables Integration and Interconnection

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What has the project received?

B. An acknowledgement of application Q314

The case establishes submission and acknowledgement, while the substantive reviews remain open.

2. What does 120 kW describe?

A. Proposed nameplate power

Kilowatts measure power, and the brief labels this figure as proposed nameplate capacity.

3. Which status is supported?

C. Application acknowledged; inverter data incomplete; metering review open

The accurate status preserves both the completed administrative step and the unresolved reviews.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which presentation line is accurate?

D. Q314 acknowledged; technical reviews open; no operating permission issued

The accurate line separates receipt, ongoing review, and the absence of permission.

2. Which unit measures energy rather than power?

B. kWh

A kilowatt-hour measures energy, whereas a kilowatt measures power.

3. What follows from submitting the missing inverter data?

A. That input can be reviewed; other requirements remain separate.

Completing one information submission does not establish outcomes for all technical or commercial matters.

4. Which statement about costs is supported?

D. Upgrade costs and allocation remain unconfirmed.

The brief explicitly establishes no confirmed upgrade cost or cost-allocation decision.

04 Conversation answers

Renewables Integration and Interconnection

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. application acknowledgement.** Turn 2. Application acknowledgement confirms receipt of Q314, not connection approval or permission to operate.
- 2. review queue.** Turn 4. The review queue identifies an administrative stage, not reserved capacity or an approved connection.
- 3. nameplate capacity.** Turn 6. Nameplate capacity is rated power on a stated basis, not annual energy or an approved export allowance.
- 4. export limit.** Turn 8. An export limit governs power sent to the network; the proposed nameplate rating does not establish it.
- 5. inverter.** Turn 10. Inverter data are one outstanding input; submitting them does not automatically close metering review or other requirements.
- 6. permission to operate.** Turn 12. Permission to operate is the relevant required authorization; an internal target date does not supply it.
- 7. network upgrades.** Turn 14. Network upgrades are changes to network facilities; their scope and cost are unconfirmed here.
- 8. cost allocation.** Turn 16. Cost allocation assigns costs to parties; identifying technical work does not itself settle who pays.
- 9. metering arrangement.** Turn 18. The metering arrangement remains under review, separate from the completed administrative receipt of the application.
- 10. interconnection agreement.** Turn 20. The interconnection agreement sets connection terms, distinct from the application and any separate operating requirements.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. Z206

Developer: "The application reference is Z206."

Z206 is the identifier supplied for the separate acknowledged application.

2. 75

Coordinator: "The proposed nameplate power is 75 kW."

Seventy-five is the proposed power rating, not annual energy output.

3. open

Developer: "Metering review remains open."

The case explicitly identifies metering review as still open.

4. unissued

Coordinator: "Permission to operate is unissued."

The brief says no permission to operate has been issued.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Asset Management and Maintenance

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is Option A's ten-year purchase-and-maintenance total?

C. \$30,000

Ten years of \$2,000 maintenance plus the \$10,000 purchase equals \$30,000.

2. What is Option B's corresponding total?

C. \$24,000

Ten years of \$1,000 maintenance plus the \$14,000 purchase equals \$24,000.

3. What does the supplied comparison establish?

B. B is \$6,000 lower on this limited undiscounted basis.

The arithmetic favors B on the stated basis but excludes several costs and technical questions.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Why is lowest-cost choice unsupported for A?

D. It uses purchase price while ignoring the supplied recurring maintenance difference.

A is cheaper upfront, but the supplied ten-year maintenance comparison favors B.

2. At \$1,600 annual maintenance, what would B total over ten years?

C. \$30,000

Fourteen thousand plus ten times sixteen hundred equals thirty thousand dollars.

3. Which label fits the original calculation?

A. Ten-year undiscounted purchase-and-maintenance comparison

The calculation includes only the stated purchase and maintenance amounts without discounting.

4. What remains necessary before a full decision?

C. Assess omitted costs, technical suitability, and the relevant decision criteria.

The limited arithmetic leaves material financial and technical matters unresolved.

05 Conversation answers

Asset Management and Maintenance

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. purchase price. Turn 2. Purchase price is the acquisition amount only; the slide incorrectly uses it to describe the entire cost choice.

2. assessment horizon. Turn 4. The assessment horizon is the ten-year period used to multiply recurring annual costs and compare the options.

3. recurring cost. Turn 6. The recurring maintenance cost accumulates over the ten-year period and reverses the ranking based on purchase price alone.

4. cost boundary. Turn 8. The cost boundary identifies included and excluded costs, preventing the partial comparison from appearing to cover all ownership effects.

5. Total cost of ownership. Turn 10. Total cost of ownership requires an explicit scope of relevant ownership costs; this exercise supplies only purchase and maintenance.

6. sensitivity analysis. Turn 12. Sensitivity analysis changes an assumption to test its effect; here it examines a higher annual maintenance amount for B.

7. Technical equivalence. Turn 14. Technical equivalence concerns ability to meet the required performance, which financial equality on a limited basis does not establish.

8. residual value. Turn 16. Residual value is the value remaining at the assessment horizon; it is excluded and has not been estimated here.

9. discounted cash flow. Turn 18. Discounted cash flow uses an explicit discount-rate basis for future amounts; the supplied arithmetic deliberately does not do that.

10. decision criteria. Turn 20. Decision criteria include the factors needed for the actual choice; limited cost arithmetic does not settle every financial or technical consideration.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 13,000

Analyst: "C totals \$13,000."

Eight thousand plus five years at one thousand equals thirteen thousand.

2. 12,000

Manager: "D totals \$12,000."

Ten thousand plus five years at four hundred equals twelve thousand.

3. 1,000

Analyst: "D is \$1,000 lower on this basis."

The difference between thirteen thousand and twelve thousand is one thousand.

4. other

Manager: "The comparison excludes other costs."

The setup includes purchase and maintenance only, leaving other cost categories outside the calculation.

06 Briefing and language checks

Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. How many requested crews are confirmed?

D. Three

The brief confirms three of the six requested crews, with three still unconfirmed.

2. How many of the confirmed crews have arrived at staging?

C. One

One confirmed crew is at staging; the other two confirmed crews are en route.

3. How many lodging spaces remain pending?

A. Eight

Twenty were requested and twelve confirmed, leaving eight spaces pending.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which crew summary avoids double counting?

D. Six requested; three confirmed, comprising one arrived and two en route

The arrived and en-route counts are subsets of the three confirmed crews.

2. Which lodging statement is supported?

D. Twelve confirmed; eight pending from a request for twenty

The brief gives twenty requested and twelve confirmed, leaving eight pending.

3. What does the 20:00 commitment promise?

C. A new status update

Sofia accepts a communication commitment, not a guarantee of resource delivery or service restoration.

4. What follows from a crew arriving at staging?

B. Arrival is established, while other required deployment stages remain separate.

Arrival does not itself establish briefing, qualification verification, or authorization for work.

06 Conversation answers

Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. shift handover. Turn 2. The shift handover transfers information and responsibility without changing the actual confirmation or arrival status of resources.

2. en route. Turn 4. En route means traveling; these two confirmed crews have not yet arrived at staging.

3. situation report. Turn 6. The situation report must preserve actual categories and counts, correcting the unsupported claim of six available crews.

4. resource shortfall. Turn 8. The resource shortfall is requested minus confirmed capacity, here eight pending lodging spaces.

5. request owner. Turn 10. The request owner accepts follow-up responsibility, which does not itself confirm the missing crews or lodging.

6. status reconciliation. Turn 12. Status reconciliation checks consistent resource reporting and prevents duplicate counting before the next update.

7. staging location. Turn 14. The staging location is an assembly point; arrival does not establish readiness or deployment authorization.

8. Deployment authorization. Turn 16. Deployment authorization permits specified work; the logistics snapshot supplies neither that authorization nor a restoration promise.

9. estimated time of arrival. Turn 18. Estimated time of arrival concerns reaching the destination; confirmed participation does not establish that estimate.

10. Lodging allocation. Turn 20. Lodging allocation must use confirmed capacity: twelve spaces are confirmed, with eight still pending.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. five

Coordinator: "The confirmed crew total is five."

Two at staging plus three en route make five confirmed crews.

2. three

Receiver: "The unconfirmed crew count is three."

Eight requested minus five confirmed leaves three unconfirmed crews.

3. fourteen

Coordinator: "Confirmed lodging spaces total fourteen."

Fourteen is the supplied count of confirmed accommodation spaces.

4. four

Receiver: "The lodging shortfall is four spaces."

Eighteen requested minus fourteen confirmed leaves four spaces pending.

07 Briefing and language checks

Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What measured energy change is supplied?

C. A 1,500 kWh reduction, equal to 15% of baseline use

Ten thousand minus 8,500 is 1,500 kWh, which is 15% of the baseline 10,000.

2. Which other conditions changed?

B. Weather and occupancy

The brief states milder weather and a fall in average daily occupancy from forty to thirty.

3. What has not been completed?

D. An adjusted baseline and savings-verification analysis

The observations exist, but the analysis needed to isolate a savings effect remains incomplete.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which headline is supported?

B. Metered use fell 15%; retrofit attribution remains unverified.

The readings support a consumption decline but not the causal, billing, or peak-demand claims.

2. Why do equal 30-day periods not settle attribution?

D. Weather and occupancy still differed.

Equal duration controls one comparison feature but does not remove the stated weather and occupancy differences.

3. What is the occupancy decline?

B. 25%, from 40 to 30 people

Ten fewer divided by the original forty equals twenty-five percent.

4. Which bill statement is justified?

C. Bill savings cannot be calculated from the supplied information.

Rates and billing components are missing, so consumption figures alone do not determine monetary savings.

07 Conversation answers

Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. metered consumption.** Turn 2. Metered consumption fell by 1,500 kWh; those observations alone do not establish the cause.
- 2. reporting period.** Turn 4. The reporting period had different weather and occupancy; equal duration does not make all conditions comparable.
- 3. Occupancy.** Turn 6. Occupancy fell from forty to thirty people; its contribution to the energy decline requires analysis.
- 4. adjusted baseline.** Turn 8. An adjusted baseline represents reference use under relevant comparison conditions using an explicit method, not arbitrary subtraction.
- 5. Weather normalization.** Turn 10. Weather normalization adjusts analysis to a defined weather basis; it has not been completed here.
- 6. attribution.** Turn 12. Attribution concerns how much change is due to the retrofit; that causal question remains unresolved.
- 7. Uncertainty.** Turn 14. Uncertainty limits the supported conclusion; it is not proof that the retrofit had no benefit.
- 8. bill savings.** Turn 16. Bill savings concerns money under actual billing conditions; missing rates and charges prevent a supported percentage.
- 9. measurement and verification.** Turn 18. Measurement and verification supplies the defined basis for assessing savings and must address relevant comparison conditions.
- 10. confounding factors.** Turn 20. Confounding factors complicate attribution, here weather and occupancy changes occurring alongside the retrofit.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 1,200

Analyst: "The observed reduction is 1,200 kWh."

Twelve thousand minus ten thousand eight hundred equals twelve hundred kilowatt-hours.

2. 10

Manager: "That equals 10 percent of baseline use."

Twelve hundred divided by twelve thousand equals ten percent.

3. unverified

Analyst: "Attribution to the intervention remains unverified."

Changed conditions and missing adjusted analysis prevent verified causal attribution.

4. calculable

Manager: "Monetary bill savings are not calculable."

The case supplies no billing rates or other information needed for monetary savings.

08 Briefing and language checks

Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is Year 1 SAIFI?

C. 1.2 interruptions per customer

Divide 1,200 customer interruptions by 1,000 customers to obtain 1.2.

2. What is Year 2 SAIDI?

D. 120 minutes per customer

Divide 120,000 customer-minutes by 1,000 customers to obtain 120 minutes.

3. Which overall description matches the two indices?

D. Average frequency fell while average total interruption duration rose.

SAIFI falls from 1.2 to 1.0, while SAIDI rises from 90 to 120 minutes.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which Year 1 calculation gives CAIDI?

C. 90,000 customer-minutes divided by 1,200 customer interruptions = 75 minutes

CAIDI divides accumulated customer-interruption minutes by customer interruptions, giving seventy-five minutes.

2. Which interpretation of Year 2 SAIFI is accurate?

B. The system average is one counted interruption per customer.

A system average does not require identical interruption counts or experiences for every customer.

3. What must be aligned for the comparison?

C. Definitions, reporting periods, population basis, and event coverage

Changing measurement scope can create a misleading trend even when each separate calculation is correct.

4. Which investment statement is supported?

B. The benefit remains a proposal requiring a validated basis.

No validated impact estimate is supplied, so the promised improvement is not established.

08 Conversation answers

Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. frequency.** Turn 2. Frequency concerns how often interruptions occur; SAIFI falls from 1.2 to 1.0 on the supplied customer basis.
- 2. denominator.** Turn 4. The denominator is the served-customer population used in the division, one thousand in both years of this comparison.
- 3. system average.** Turn 6. A system average summarizes the population while allowing individual customers to have different counts, including none or several.
- 4. SAIDI.** Turn 8. SAIDI is average total sustained-interruption duration per customer, calculated here as ninety and one hundred twenty minutes respectively.
- 5. duration.** Turn 10. Duration here concerns accumulated interruption time; it rose even while the average interruption count fell.
- 6. CAIDI.** Turn 12. CAIDI divides customer-minutes interrupted by customer interruptions, yielding seventy-five and one hundred twenty minutes on this consistent basis.
- 7. event coverage.** Turn 14. Event coverage identifies which interruptions are included; a trend comparison requires consistent scope rather than mixing different event sets.
- 8. reporting methodology.** Turn 16. Reporting methodology defines calculation and classification rules; changing those rules can undermine a comparison even when arithmetic is correct.
- 9. target outcome.** Turn 18. A target outcome is an intended result, not a guaranteed effect; the supplied proposal lacks a validated impact estimate.
- 10. resilience.** Turn 20. Resilience includes withstanding and recovering from disruption; a single annual average does not capture every aspect of that broader capability.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 1.5

Analyst: "SAIFI is 1.5 interruptions per customer."

Seven hundred fifty customer interruptions divided by five hundred customers equals 1.5.

2. 120

Liaison: "SAIDI is 120 minutes per customer."

Sixty thousand customer-minutes divided by five hundred customers equals one hundred twenty.

3. 80

Analyst: "CAIDI is 80 minutes per interruption."

Sixty thousand customer-minutes divided by seven hundred fifty interruptions equals eighty.

4. averages

Liaison: "These are averages, not identical individual experiences."

The measures summarize groups and do not require every customer's experience to match.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Grid Reliability and Outage Response

Timestamp the message: This is the verified status as of 16:10 local time.

State the assessment: The cause remains under assessment.

Describe crew status: A crew is assigned; arrival is not yet confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Safety, Field Work, and Switching

State the discrepancy: The work package says Q27; the switching request says Q72.

Repeat the digits: I read Q two seven in the work package.

Keep authority separate: This conversation does not authorize an operational action.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Regulatory Affairs and Rate Cases

Name the status first: The notice describes a proposal that is still under review.

State the current rate: The current example rate is ten cents per kilowatt-hour.

Calculate the current component: The current energy charge is fifty dollars.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Renewables Integration and Interconnection

Report the completed step: Application Q314 has been submitted and acknowledged.

Name the first open item: Inverter data remain incomplete.

Avoid an energy claim: It is not annual energy output in kilowatt-hours.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Asset Management and Maintenance

Identify the narrow comparison: The slide compares purchase prices only.

Explain the recurring cost: A has two thousand dollars of annual maintenance.

Preserve the exclusions: Installation, energy, downtime, disposal, and residual value are excluded.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Emergency Preparedness and Storm Response

Timestamp the handover: This is the resource position at 19:30 local time.

Break down the confirmed group: One confirmed crew is at staging and two are en route.

State lodging confirmation: Twelve spaces are confirmed and eight remain pending.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Customer Programs and Energy Efficiency

State the readings: Consumption fell from ten thousand to eight thousand five hundred kilowatt-hours.

State the denominator: That is fifteen percent of baseline consumption.

Avoid a false constant: The comparison conditions were not unchanged.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Executive Reliability and Investment Updates

Define frequency: SAIFI describes average sustained interruptions per customer.

Show the denominator: Both years use one thousand customers.

Calculate Year 2 duration: One hundred twenty thousand divided by one thousand gives one hundred twenty minutes.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

access restriction	verify access restrictions	51
adjusted baseline	calculate an adjusted baseline	59
application acknowledgement	distinguish application acknowledgement	32
approved rate	verify the approved rate	24
arc flash	assess arc-flash hazards	15
assessment horizon	define the assessment horizon	41
asset criticality	assess asset criticality	42
asset management	develop an asset-management plan	41
asset tag	reconcile the asset tag	14
attribution	qualify savings attribution	60
avoided energy use	estimate avoided energy use	60
backfeed	assess backfeed hazards	14
baseline period	define the baseline period	59
benefit estimate	validate the benefit estimate	69
bill impact	illustrate the bill impact	24
bill savings	distinguish bill savings	60
business case	review the business case	69
capital expenditure (CAPEX)	assess capital expenditure	41
clearance	verify the clearance conditions	15
commissioning	coordinate commissioning	33
communications plan	follow the communications plan	51
condition-based maintenance	evaluate condition-based maintenance	41
confounding factor	account for confounding factors	60
cooling degree days	use cooling degree days	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

corrective maintenance	track corrective maintenance	41
cost allocation	clarify cost allocation	33
cost boundary	state the cost boundary	42
cost of service	assess cost of service	23
counterfactual	establish the counterfactual basis	69
credential verification	complete credential verification	51
crew arrival	verify crew arrival	5
crew assignment	confirm the crew assignment	5
crew roster	reconcile the crew roster	50
curtailment	explain curtailment risk	33
Customer Average Interruption Duration Index (CAIDI)	distinguish CAIDI from SAIDI	68
customer class	identify the customer class	23
customer interruption	count customer interruptions	68
customer-minute interrupted	sum customer-minutes interrupted	68
customers served	state customers served	68
damage assessment	coordinate damage assessment	5
decision criteria	agree decision criteria	42
deenergized	establish deenergized status	14
demand charge	explain a demand charge	23
demobilization	plan demobilization	50
denominator	check the denominator	68
deployment authorization	verify deployment authorization	50
discounted cash flow	distinguish discounted cash flow	42
dispatch	contact dispatch	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

disposal cost include disposal costs	42
distributed energy resource (DER) assess a distributed energy resource	32
distribution restore distribution service	5
distribution of outcomes examine the distribution of outcomes	69
docket locate the docket	24
document reconciliation complete document reconciliation	15
downtime account for downtime	42
duration explain interruption duration	69
effective date verify the effective date	24
electric grid maintain the electric grid	5
emergency operations center (EOC) support the emergency operations center	50
en route report crews en route	50
energized verify energized status	14
energy conservation encourage energy conservation	59
energy conservation measure (ECM) evaluate an energy conservation measure	59
energy efficiency improve energy efficiency	59
equipment identifier verify the equipment identifier	14
estimated restoration time (ERT) update the estimated restoration time	5
estimated time of arrival (ETA) verify the estimated time of arrival	50
event coverage align event coverage	68
export limit verify the export limit	33
facilities study review the facilities study	32
failure mode assess a failure mode	42
fatigue management follow fatigue-management requirements	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

feasibility study	review a feasibility study	32
feeder	identify the affected feeder	5
field lead	notify the field lead	14
filing	review a regulatory filing	24
fixed charge	distinguish the fixed charge	23
frequency	explain interruption frequency	69
gross savings	distinguish gross savings	60
grounding	follow authorized grounding requirements	15
hearing	attend a regulatory hearing	24
heating degree days	use heating degree days	59
hold point	maintain the hold point	15
hosting capacity	assess hosting capacity	32
incident command	coordinate with incident command	50
independent variable	identify relevant independent variables	60
induced voltage	assess induced-voltage hazards	15
interconnection	review the interconnection	32
interconnection agreement	review the interconnection agreement	33
intervenor	identify an intervenor	24
inverter	submit inverter data	32
investment proposal	assess an investment proposal	69
isolation	verify isolation requirements	14
kilowatt (kW)	state demand in kilowatts	6
kilowatt-hour (kWh)	measure energy in kilowatt-hours	6
life-cycle cost	assess life-cycle cost	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

load monitor system load	6
lockout/tagout follow applicable lockout/tagout procedures	15
lodging allocation confirm lodging allocation	51
logistics coordinate response logistics	51
maintenance interval review the maintenance interval	41
major event day state major-event-day treatment	68
measurement and verification (M&V) develop a measurement and verification plan	59
metered consumption compare metered consumption	59
metering arrangement confirm the metering arrangement	33
minimum approach distance observe the applicable minimum approach distance	15
mobilization track mobilization status	50
momentary interruption distinguish momentary interruptions	68
mutual assistance request mutual assistance	50
nameplate capacity state nameplate capacity	32
net savings assess net savings	60
network upgrade assess network upgrades	33
non-export arrangement review a non-export arrangement	33
occupancy track occupancy changes	60
operating authority preserve operating authority	15
operating expenditure (OPEX) forecast operating expenditure	41
operating hours document operating hours	60
operational period identify the operational period	51
outage report an outage	5
outage footprint verify the outage footprint	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

outage management system (OMS)	update the outage management system	6
peak demand	assess peak demand	6
performance commitment	qualify the performance commitment	69
permission to operate (PTO)	verify permission to operate	33
persistence	evaluate savings persistence	60
photovoltaic (PV)	develop a photovoltaic project	32
planning assumption	label a planning assumption	6
power quality	assess power quality	33
preventive maintenance	schedule preventive maintenance	41
proposed rate	distinguish the proposed rate	24
protection settings	verify protection settings	33
public utilities commission	identify the public utilities commission	23
purchase price	compare purchase prices	41
qualified worker	verify qualified-worker status	15
queue position	confirm queue position	32
rate base	determine the rate base	23
rate case	explain the rate case	23
rate design	explain the rate design	24
rate of return	explain the rate of return	23
rate rider	identify a rate rider	24
ratepayer	communicate with ratepayers	23
reactive power	assess reactive-power requirements	33
read-back	perform an exact read-back	15
rebound effect	assess the rebound effect	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

recurring cost	estimate recurring costs	41
reliability trend	interpret the reliability trend	69
remaining useful life	estimate remaining useful life	42
replacement cycle	plan the replacement cycle	42
reporting methodology	document the reporting methodology	68
reporting period	identify the reporting period	59
request owner	identify the request owner	51
residual value	estimate residual value	42
resilience	distinguish resilience from a single reliability index	69
resource confirmation	obtain resource confirmation	50
resource request	track a resource request	50
resource shortfall	identify a resource shortfall	51
restoration sequence	communicate the restoration sequence	6
retrofit	assess an efficiency retrofit	59
revenue requirement	review the revenue requirement	23
review queue	track the review queue	32
revision control	maintain revision control	15
sensitivity analysis	run a sensitivity analysis	42
service point	count affected service points	5
shift handover	conduct a shift handover	51
single-line diagram	consult the current single-line diagram	14
situation report	issue a situation report	51
staging location	report arrival at staging	50
status reconciliation	complete status reconciliation	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

status snapshot timestamp the status snapshot	6
substation identify the supplying substation	5
supervisory control and data acquisition (SCADA) interpret SCADA information	6
sustained interruption define sustained interruptions	68
switching order verify the switching order	14
switching request check the switching request	14
system average qualify the system average	69
System Average Interruption Duration Index (SAIDI) explain SAIDI in minutes	68
System Average Interruption Frequency Index (SAIFI) explain SAIFI as frequency	68
system impact study assess the system impact study	32
system operator contact the system operator	14
target outcome distinguish the target outcome	69
tariff consult the current tariff	23
technical equivalence establish technical equivalence	42
telemetry verify telemetry status	6
test year identify the test year	24
total cost of ownership compare total cost of ownership	41
transmission coordinate transmission operations	5
uncertainty report savings uncertainty	60
update commitment keep the update commitment	6
usage assumption state the usage assumption	24
volumetric charge calculate the volumetric charge	23
weather normalization apply weather normalization	59
work package review the work package	14

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] U.S. Energy Information Administration. Reliability metrics, Electric Power Annual, Table 11.3.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for SAIDI, SAIFI, CAIDI, reporting scope, and major-event distinctions. All reliability figures in this book are invented teaching examples, not reported utility performance. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] U.S. Department of Energy. Measurement and Verification Options for Federal Energy- and Water-Saving Projects.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for measurement, baseline adjustments, weather, and occupancy. The book does not prescribe an actual savings-verification method or certify program results. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] U.S. Department of Energy. Solar Energy Guide for Homebuilders.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for separating applications, interconnection arrangements, and permission to operate. Actual requirements vary by utility, project, and jurisdiction. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] California Public Utilities Commission. Understanding How the CPUC Processes a General Rate Case.

[Open the original source](#)

A jurisdiction-specific example of reviewing utility proposals and customer impacts. The fictional rate case does not reproduce California rates, procedures, or a real customer bill. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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